

OPTIMAL TEST FUNCTIONS FOR K-UNSTABLE TORIC VARIETIES AND SECONDARY POLYTOPES

LI SHENG AND YI YAO

ABSTRACT. For K-unstable toric varieties, Székelyhidi's optimal test-function Θ_P is a mysterious concave function over the moment polytope P , which encodes the limit behavior of Calabi flow. This paper aims to quantize Θ_P by the maximal destabilizers for Chow-stability. We determine these destabilizers by a combinatorial object called shortest GKZ vector, which is the least norm point on the secondary polytope associated to the lattice point set $P \cap k^{-1}\mathbb{Z}^n$. We show that these maximal Chow-destabilizers converge to Θ_P in L^2 as $k \rightarrow \infty$, without any compactness assumption. Under a C^0 -precompactness assumption the convergence is uniform. It may provide an algorithm to detect K-unstability of toric varieties.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Consider a seemingly innocent variational problem. Let P be a full-dimensional polytope in $\mathbb{R}^n$, one wants to minimize the functional

$$\Psi(\eta) = \frac{1}{2} \int_P \eta^2 dx + \int_{\partial P} \eta d\sigma, \quad \eta : P \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \text{ is convex}, \quad (1.1)$$

where dx is Lebesgue measure and boundary measure $d\sigma$ is proportional to the Lebesgue measure on each facet. If one decreases the boundary integral, convexity will force the L^2 -norm to increase. Indeed, Ψ admits a unique minimizer f^* . In most situations, f^* is affine. It remains unknown whether f^* is always piecewise affine and how to determine it numerically.

This variational problem originates from Székelyhidi [Szé08]. Its minimizer relates to the long-time behavior of the Calabi flow on the toric Kähler manifold associated to P . We discuss this context below.

Let (X, L) be the polarized toric Kähler manifold induced by a lattice Delzant polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}} := M \otimes \mathbb{R}$, where M is a lattice of rank n . As an instance of Yau–Tian–Donaldson conjecture, the existence of extremal metrics in class $c_1(L)$ is expected to be equivalent to a stability condition on P , see [Don02; Szé14]. With the aid of torus symmetry, the existence can be reduced to the solvability of a fourth-order PDE on P . The stability condition is called the relative K-polystability, which requires that the relative Donaldson–Futaki invariant

$$\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}(\eta) := \int_{\partial P} \eta d\sigma - \int_P \eta \ell_P dx \geq 0$$

for all rational piecewise affine convex functions η , with equality only for affine η . See §4.1 for details.

It is widely accepted that this stability condition needs to be strengthened to make the equivalence hold. There are two kinds of strengthened conditions: uniform K-stabilities [Der16] and testing more functions [Szé15]. To date, various versions of equivalence have been established, refer to [Don08; CLS18; CC21; His20; Li22; LLS23; Jub23; NS21] and their references. Meanwhile, there are partial criteria to verify stability practically, see [ZZ08; YZ19].

Optimal test function Θ_P . The unstable case has received less attention, see [WZ11; WZ14; Sek18; YZ19; Ara+23] for examples. When P is relatively K-unstable (i.e. $\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}$ may be negative), [Szé08] showed the minimization problem

$$\inf \left\{ \frac{\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}(\eta)}{\|\eta\|_2} \mid 0 \neq \eta \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P) \right\}, \quad \|\eta\|_2^2 := \int_P \eta^2 dx$$

admits a unique minimizer $\ell_P - \Theta_P$ up to scaling, see (4.1) for the enlarged space $\mathcal{C}_1(P)$ of convex functions. Proposition 40 shows that $-\Theta_P$ is actually the unique minimizer of Ψ (1.1) above. Let $\Theta_P = \ell_P$ when P is relatively K-semistable (i.e. $\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}} \geq 0$). We call this concave function Θ_P ($= B$ in [Szé08]) the *optimal test function* for P .

The boundedness of Θ_P is proved by Li, Lian and the first author [LLS23]. Repeat their proof, we find that it can yield stronger results.

Theorem 1 ([LLS23] see §4.2). *The optimal test function Θ_P can extend to a concave function on the whole space. In particular, Θ_P is continuous up to the boundary of P , and the subdifferential set $\partial(-\Theta_P)(\text{int}P)$ is bounded.*

As [Szé08] showed, Θ_P encodes important information of X . For instance, if the Calabi flow admits long-time solution, then the scalar curvature (as function on P) would converge to Θ_P . More interestingly, when Θ_P is piecewise affine, it induces a polyhedral

decomposition of P , then every subpolytope is semistable in a certain sense, see Theorem 38. Hence Θ_P is analogous to the Harder–Narasimhan filtration for the unstable holomorphic vector bundles, where the monotonicity of the slopes of quotient bundles mimics the concavity of Θ_P . To the authors' knowledge, there is no explicit example of Θ_P so far, see [Sek18] for examples with zero boundary measure. By the way, the optimal test-functions for Ding-stability of toric Fano varieties have been determined in [Yao22]. They are always piecewise affine.

Maximal destabilizers for K-stability. Optimal test function Θ_P is a realization of maximal K-destabilizers for general K-unstable Kähler manifold (X, L) . Recall that the constant scalar curvature Kähler metrics are critical points of K-energy. When (X, L) is K-unstable, Xia [Xia21] show that there is a unique (modulo parallel relation) finite-energy geodesic ray along which the K-energy decreases fastest. By [BBJ21; Li22], this ray can be encoded into a non-Archimedean metric on L , which we call the *maximal K-destabilizer* of (X, L) . In the toric setting, with the aid of symmetry, it reduces to Θ_P , see [Yao25b, Example 44].

Maximal destabilizers for Chow-stability. The second author [Yao25b] suggests to study the maximal K-destabilizers via the Chow-stability. Since its birth in [Tia97], K-stability has been closely connected with Chow-stability. Let $\iota_k : X \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}R_k^*$ be the Kodaira embedding, where $R_k := H^0(X, kL)$. Chow-stability means the GIT stability of Chow-form attached to $\iota_k(X)$. Ross and Thomas [RT06] showed that asymptotic Chow-semistability can imply K-semistability. Hence if (X, L) is K-unstable, then (X, kL) is Chow-unstable for sufficiently large k . We can consider the *maximal Chow-destabilizer* for $\iota_k(X)$, which is defined as a filtration on R_k induced by the 1-ps of $\mathrm{SL}(R_k)$ minimizing the Chow-weights.

A natural question is whether the maximal Chow-destabilizer converges to the maximal K-destabilizer in a certain sense as $k \rightarrow \infty$. This is similar to the stable case, in which Donaldson [Don01] used balanced metrics to approximate cscK metrics. One difference is that there is no Euler–Lagrange equation for maximal destabilizers, only a variational inequality.

This paper study this problem for toric varieties. Our main results are

- (1) We determine the maximal Chow-destabilizers by a combinatorial object called the shortest GKZ vector, see Theorem 2 below.
- (2) We show that the expected convergence holds in L^2 without any compactness assumption. Under a C^0 -precompactness assumption the convergence is uniform, see Theorem 5 below.

Maximal Chow-destabilizers for toric varieties. For toric varieties, an explicit formula of Chow-weights (for 1-ps in the diagonal torus) is obtained in [KSZ92], see also [GKZ94; Ono13]. We will derive this formula via the NA expression of Chow-weight obtained in [Yao25b].

Let $(X^{\mathrm{an}}, L^{\mathrm{an}})$ be the Berkovich analytification of (X, L) with the trivially-normed base field $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\mathcal{N}(R_k)$ be the space of NA norms (or filtrations) on R_k . Then the Chow-weights for subvariety $\iota_k(X)$ are given by functional

$$M_k : \mathcal{N}(R_k) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad M_k(\chi) = \mathbb{E}(\mathrm{FS}_k(\chi)) - E_k(\chi), \quad (1.2)$$

where $\mathrm{FS}_k(\chi)$ (2.6) is the NA Fubini–Study metric induced by χ , $\mathbb{E}$ is NA Monge–Ampère energy, and $E_k(\chi)$ is the average of jumping numbers (2.14).

If $\iota_k(X)$ is Chow-unstable (i.e. $\inf M_k < 0$), the maximal Chow-destabilizer χ_k^* is the unique (up to scaling) minimizer of the functional

$$M_k(\chi) / \|\chi\|_2, \quad \chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k) \setminus \{\chi_{tr}\},$$

see [Yao25b, Theorem 1]. Moreover, χ_k^* is invariant under all automorphisms of (X, L) , that allows us to search the minimizer only among the invariant norms.

Apply these facts to toric variety (X, L) given by a lattice polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$. It suffices to consider the space $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ of torus-invariant norm on R_k . This space can be identified with

$$\mathbb{R}^{P_k} = \{f : P_k \rightarrow \mathbb{R}\}, \quad P_k = P \cap k^{-1}M.$$

On the other hand, via the tropicalization map, the space $\text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L)$ of invariant continuous psh metrics on L^{an} can be identified with the space $\mathcal{C}(P)$ of convex functions on P (continuous up to ∂P). Then the NA Fubini–Study map FS_k and super-norm map SN_k (2.12) are identified with the convex envelope $\vee$ (2.10) and restriction respectively.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T & \xrightleftharpoons[\text{SN}_k]{\text{FS}_k} & \text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L) \\ (2.4) \downarrow \simeq & & \simeq \downarrow (2.9) \\ \mathbb{R}^{P_k} & \xrightleftharpoons[\text{restriction}]{\text{convex envelope } \vee} & \mathcal{C}(P) \end{array}$$

The Chow-weight M_k (1.2) is identified with

$$M_{P_k}(f) := \frac{1}{|P_k|} \sum_{u \in P_k} f(u) - \frac{1}{V_P} \int_P f^{\vee} dx, \quad \forall f \in \mathbb{R}^{P_k},$$

which is consistent with the formula in [KSZ92; Ono13].

We analyze M_{P_k} via Gelfand–Kapranov–Zelevinsky’s secondary polytope $\Sigma(P_k) \subset \mathbb{R}^{P_k}$, which encodes all subdivisions of (P, P_k) and the refinement relations between them. Despite its complicated structure, we are only concerned with the least-norm point on $\Sigma(P_k)$, which we call the *shortest GKZ vector* $\sigma_k \in \Sigma(P_k)$.

Theorem 2 (see Theorem 27, 33). *For toric variety (X, L) given by lattice polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$, suppose that $\iota_k : X \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}R_k^*$ is an embedding ($k \geq n - 1$ is enough).*

(1) *Subvariety $\iota_k(X) \subset \mathbb{P}R_k^*$ is Chow-semistable (w.r.t. the action of $\text{SL}(R_k)$) if and only if the constant vector $|P_k|^{-1} \in \Sigma(P_k)$, or equivalently $\sigma_k \equiv |P_k|^{-1}$.*

(2) *When $\iota_k(X)$ is Chow-unstable, the minimizers (i.e. maximal Chow-destabilizers) of*

$$\inf \left\{ \frac{M_k(\chi)}{\|\chi\|_2} \mid \chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k) \setminus \{\chi_{tr}\} \right\} \quad (1.3)$$

are of the form $a\chi_k^$ ($a > 0$), where χ_k^* is diagonalized by the basis $\{s_{u,k}\}_{u \in P_k}$ (2.3) and satisfies*

$$\chi_k^*(s_{u,k}) = |P_k|^{-1} - \sigma_k(u), \quad \forall u \in P_k.$$

With respect to the diagonal torus action, the equivalence in (1) has been obtained in [Ono13]. The symmetry of maximal destabilizers enables the equivalence to hold also for $\text{SL}(R_k)$.

Shortest GKZ vectors for general point sets. We have not found any existing studies on the shortest GKZ vectors, which may be of independent interest for combinatorics. Thus we investigate it for general point sets that generalize P_k .

A marked polytope (Q, A) is a polytope $Q \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$ with marking point set A such that $Q = \text{conv}(A)$. A triangulation of (Q, A) gives rise to a GKZ vector $g_T : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, see (3.8). The secondary polytope $\Sigma(A) \subset \mathbb{R}^A$ is the convex hull of all GKZ vectors which never contains the origin. Its faces (vertices) are in one-to-one correspondence to the regular subdivisions (triangulations) of (Q, A) .

Shortest GKZ vector σ_A is the unique point on $\Sigma(A)$ with the least norm, which may not be a vertex of $\Sigma(A)$. Note that σ_A depends only on affine relations among the points in A , not on the background metric. One may think of σ_A as representing the most uniform subdivision of (Q, A) in some sense.

Theorem 3 (Theorem 34, 35). *For any marked polytope (Q, A) with shortest GKZ vector $\sigma_A \in \Sigma(A)$, we have*

- (1) σ_A is convex, that means the restriction of the convex envelope $\sigma_A^\vee|_A = \sigma_A$.
- (2) $\sigma_A : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is positive at each point.

The convexity reminds us the concavity of Θ , see the remark after [Szé08, Proposition 9]. By (2), we know that if σ_A is a vertex of $\Sigma(A)$, then the corresponding triangulation must use all points in A .

Asymptotics of maximum Chow-destabilizers. Back to our motivation: connecting maximal K-destabilizers with maximal Chow-destabilizers. Now, the problem is reduced to connecting Θ with the shortest GKZ vectors σ_k attached to P_k .

A natural idea is to connect the variational problem behind Θ and σ_k . In appendix A, we verify the following folklore expansion of Riemann sum

$$\sum_{u \in P_k} \eta(u) = \int_P \eta \, dx \cdot k^n + \frac{1}{2} \int_{\partial P} \eta \, d\sigma \cdot k^{n-1} + o(k^{n-1}), \quad \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P),$$

which may fail if η is merely continuous. It motivates us to introduce a quantum functional

$$\Psi_k(\eta) := \frac{1}{2k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k} \eta(u)^2 + \frac{2}{k^{n-1}} \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} \eta(u) - k^n \int_P \eta \, dx \right), \quad \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P).$$

Actually, Ψ_k is the toric version of general functional $\check{Q}_k$ in [Yao25b]. We have

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_k(\eta) = \Psi(\eta), \quad \forall \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P).$$

Recall that $-\Theta_P$ is the unique minimizer of Ψ .

Theorem 4 (see §5.1). *Quantum functional Ψ_k admits a unique minimizer*

$$\psi_k := 2V_P k^{n+1} \sigma_k^\vee - 2k \tag{1.4}$$

over $\mathcal{C}(P)$.

Its proof relies on the convexity of σ_k . The following is another main result.

Theorem 5 (see §5.2). *The minimizer sequence ψ_k (1.4) converges to $-\Theta_P$ in $L^2(P)$, without any precompactness assumption. More precisely,*

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k} \psi_k(u)^2 = \int_P \Theta_P^2 \, dx. \tag{1.5}$$

Consequently,

$$V_P k^n \sigma_k^\vee = 1 - \frac{\Theta_P}{2k} + o_{L^2}(k^{-1}). \tag{1.6}$$

If, in addition, $\{\psi_k\}$ is C^0 -precompact, then ψ_k converges uniformly to $-\Theta_P$, and hence

$$V_P k^n \sigma_k^\vee = 1 - \frac{\Theta_P}{2k} + o(k^{-1}), \quad k \rightarrow \infty. \tag{1.7}$$

This means that the maximal Chow-destabilizer can quantize the maximal K-destabilizer.

The L^2 statement follows from a Γ -convergence argument together with a compactness lemma for convex lattice functions. The lemma allows positive mass to concentrate near ∂P , but shows that such concentration has a nonnegative cost in the limiting functional; minimality then rules it out. By Arzelà–Ascoli theorem, C^0 -precompactness is equivalent to $\{\psi_k\}$ being uniformly bounded and equicontinuous. Establishing this stronger compactness remains open.

If (1.7) holds, it may provide a method to detect the K-unstability of P . When P is K-unstable, (1.7) suggests taking $\sigma_k^\vee$ as the test function for DF-invariant $\mathbb{M}_P$. Once k is sufficiently large, we can detect K-unstability. This may be overly optimistic, since σ_k is hard to compute. There are computer programs to obtain secondary polytopes, such as [Ram02; JJK; Whi]. We write a program [Yao25a] to compute σ_k based on [Whi], yet it can only handle up to 15 points within a tolerable time on our desktop computer. We need an algorithm to find σ_k that avoids visiting the whole secondary polytope. See §5.2 for other remaining questions.

Organizations. In §2, we review the structure of Berkovich analytification of toric varieties. Translate the Fubini–Study and super-norm operators into simple operations in convex-analysis, in order to derive the formula of Chow-weights in §3.1. In §3, we study the minimization problem for Chow-weight via the secondary polytopes, and investigate the shortest GKZ vectors in §3.6. In §4, we collect some known properties of Θ_P , and then study the asymptotics of Chow-destabilizers. In appendix A, we establish a folklore expansion of Riemann sums.

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2. NON-ARCHIMEDEAN QUANTIZATION ON TORIC VARIETIES

In this section, we review the non-Archimedean pluripotential theory on toric varieties. We reduce the Fubini–Study map and super-norm map to some convex-analysis operations. The main references are [BPS14; BJ24].

2.1. Toric varieties. We review the structure of toric varieties, refer to [CLS11] for details.

Let M be a lattice of rank n . It induce a group algebra

$$\mathbb{C}[M] := \left\{ \text{finite sum } \sum_{m \in M} c_m x^m \mid c_m \in \mathbb{C} \right\}$$

whose product is defined by $x^m \cdot x^{m'} = x^{m+m'}$. There is a coproduct

$$\mathbb{C}[M] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[M] \otimes \mathbb{C}[M], \quad x^m \mapsto x^m \otimes x^m,$$

which makes $\mathbb{T} := \text{Spec} \mathbb{C}[M]$ a group scheme. All $\mathbb{C}$ -points of $\mathbb{T}$ constitute the complex torus group $T_{\mathbb{C}} := \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(M, \mathbb{C}^*) = N \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{C}^*$, where N is the dual lattice of M . The characters of $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ are given by

$$x^m : T_{\mathbb{C}} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^*, \quad x^m(n \otimes z) = z^{\langle m, n \rangle}, \quad n \in N, \quad z \in \mathbb{C}^*.$$

The cocharacters $\mathbb{C}^* \rightarrow T_{\mathbb{C}}$ are given by $z \mapsto n \otimes z, \forall n \in N$. Let $T_{\mathbb{R}} := N \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{S}^1$ be the compact torus.

A toric variety X is a complex normal variety equipped with a faithful $\mathbb{T}$ -action and X has an open dense orbit. It turns out that X can be described by a combinatorial structure

called a fan. A fan $\mathcal{F}$ is a finite collection of rational polyhedral convex cones in $N_{\mathbb{R}} := N \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{R}$, see [CLS11, Definition 3.1.2]. It induces a toric variety $X_{\mathcal{F}}$, which is briefly reviewed below.

First, each cone $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}$ induces a finitely-generated semigroup $M_{\sigma} := M \cap \sigma^{\vee}$, where $\sigma^{\vee} = \{x \in M_{\mathbb{R}} \mid \langle x, \cdot \rangle \geq 0 \text{ on } \sigma\}$ is the dual cone. Then M_{σ} induces a finitely generated algebra $\mathbb{C}[M_{\sigma}]$ in the same way as $\mathbb{C}[M]$. We obtain affine variety $X_{\sigma} := \text{Spec} \mathbb{C}[M_{\sigma}]$, which carries a $\mathbb{T}$ -action defined by the morphism

$$\mathbb{C}[M_{\sigma}] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[M] \otimes \mathbb{C}[M_{\sigma}], \quad x^m \rightarrow x^m \otimes x^m, \quad \forall m \in M_{\sigma}.$$

For two cones $\sigma \subset \sigma'$ in $\mathcal{F}$, since $M_{\sigma} \supset M_{\sigma'}$, there is a $\mathbb{T}$ -equivariant embedding $X_{\sigma} \hookrightarrow X_{\sigma'}$. Then glueing $\{X_{\sigma} \mid \sigma \in \mathcal{F}\}$ together via these embeddings, we obtain toric variety $X_{\mathcal{F}}$, which is proper if and only if $N_{\mathbb{R}}$ is the union of all cones in $\mathcal{F}$.

Let $\mathcal{F}(i) \subset \mathcal{F}$ be the subset of i -dimensional cones. These cones correspond one-to-one to the $\mathbb{T}$ -orbits in $X_{\mathcal{F}}$ of dimension $n - i$, see [CLS11, §3.2]. Denote by $O(\sigma)$ the orbit corresponding to $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}$. Its Zariski closure $V(\sigma)$ is also a toric variety of dimension $n - i$, and we have $V(\sigma) = \bigsqcup_{\tau \supset \sigma} O(\tau)$. For each 1-dimensional cone $\rho \in \mathcal{F}(1)$, let $n_{\rho} \in N$ be the primitive generator and $D_{\rho} := V(\rho)$ the associated prime divisor. For any $m \in M$, x^m defines a rational function on $X_{\mathcal{F}}$ and we have

$$\text{div}(x^m) = \sum_{\rho \in \mathcal{F}(1)} \langle m, n_{\rho} \rangle D_{\rho}. \quad (2.1)$$

Let P be a full-dimensional lattice polytope in $M_{\mathbb{R}}$. It induces an (inner) normal fan

$$\mathcal{F}_P := \{\sigma_F : F \text{ is a face of } P\},$$

where

$$\sigma_F := \left\{ y \in N_{\mathbb{R}} \mid \min_P \langle \cdot, y \rangle = \langle x, y \rangle, \quad \forall x \in F \right\}.$$

Let $\{n_{\rho}\}$ be the primitive inner normal vectors of the facets, then we have

$$P = \{x \in M_{\mathbb{R}} \mid \langle x, n_{\rho} \rangle + a_{\rho} \geq 0, \quad \forall \rho \in \mathcal{F}_P(1)\},$$

where $a_{\rho} \in \mathbb{Z}$ since the vertices of P are lattice point.

Consider the toric variety X_P induced by the fan $\mathcal{F}_P$. Define

$$D_P := \sum_{\rho \in \mathcal{F}_P(1)} a_{\rho} D_{\rho},$$

which is an ample and base-point-free Cartier divisor on X_P , see [CLS11, Proposition 6.1.10]. Let $L_P = \mathcal{O}_{X_P}(D_P)$ be the associated line bundle. In the next, subscript “ P ” will be omitted since P is fixed. We will fix a rational section s_D of L such that $\text{div}(s_D) = D$. The $\mathbb{T}$ -action on X can be lifted to L in a unique way such that s_D is equivariant. Let $m_{\sigma} \in M$ be the vertex of P corresponding to a maximal cone $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}_P(n)$. By the formula (2.1),

$$s_{\sigma} := x^{m_{\sigma}} s_D \in H^0(X, L) \quad (2.2)$$

is a global section and nonvanishing on X_{σ} . We will take s_{σ} as a frame of L over X_{σ} .

For any $k \geq 1$, we regard the rescaled lattice set

$$P_k := P \cap k^{-1}M$$

as the “quantization” of P at level k . For each $u \in P_k$, $s_{u,k} := x^{ku} s_D^k$ is a global section of kL . The action of $t \in T_{\mathbb{C}}$ on $s_{u,k}$ is $t \cdot s_{u,k} = x^{ku}(t^{-1})_{s_{u,k}}$. With respect to the $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -action, we have a weight decomposition

$$R_k := H^0(X, kL) = \bigoplus_{u \in P_k} \mathbb{C} \cdot s_{u,k}. \quad (2.3)$$

In particular, $N_k := \dim R_k = |P_k| = V_P k^n + \frac{1}{2} V_{\partial P} k^{n-1} + O(k^{n-2})$.

Since kL is globally generated for any $k \geq 1$, its global sections induce a morphism $X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}R_k^*$. By [CLS11, Proposition 6.1.10], it is an embedding (kL is very ample) when $k \geq n - 1$.

2.2. Torus-invariant NA norms. Recall a NA norm $||| : R_k \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ is a norm satisfying that $|||as||| = |||s|||$ for $\forall a \in \mathbb{C}^*$ and $|||s + s'||| \leq \max(|||s|||, |||s'||||)$. We prefer to use the valutive notation $\chi = -\log |||$. A NA norm χ is equivalent to a left-continuous non-increasing filtration $(F_\chi^\lambda)_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}}$ on R_k , that is $F_\chi^\lambda = \{s \in R_k \mid \chi(s) \geq \lambda\}$. Let $\mathcal{N}(R_k)$ be the space of NA norms, and $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ be the subspace of $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant NA norms, i.e. those satisfy $\chi(t \cdot s) = \chi(s)$ for any $t \in T_{\mathbb{C}}$ and $s \in R_k$.

Proposition 6. *A NA norm χ on R_k is $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant if and only if χ is diagonalized by the eigen-sections $\{s_{u,k} \mid u \in P_k\}$.*

Proof. For any $\chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$, the associated filtration $F^\lambda = \{s \in R_k \mid \chi(s) \geq \lambda\}$ is $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant for any λ . Since R_k is multiplicity-free, F^λ is spanned by some $s_{u,k}$. This implies that χ is diagonalized by $(s_{u,k})$. The reverse direction is trivial. $\square$

By this fact, we identify $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ with the space $\mathbb{R}^{P_k} := \{f : P_k \rightarrow \mathbb{R}\}$ via the map

$$f \mapsto \chi_f, \text{ where } \chi_f \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} c_u s_{u,k} \right) = \min \{-kf(u) \mid c_u \neq 0\}. \quad (2.4)$$

There is a Tits building structure on $\mathcal{N}(R_k)$ such that $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ is an apartment, see [Bou19].

2.3. Berkovich analytification. Let (X, L) be the polarized toric variety associated to lattice polytope P . Endowing $\mathbb{C}$ with the trivial valuation. As a set, Berkovich's analytification X^{an} is

$$X^{\text{an}} := \bigcup_{\sigma \in \mathcal{F}_P} X_\sigma^{\text{an}}, \quad X_\sigma^{\text{an}} := \{v : \mathbb{C}[M_\sigma] \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\}\},$$

where v is semivaluation extending the trivial valuation on $\mathbb{C}$. For $f \in \mathbb{C}[M_\sigma]$ and $v \in X_\sigma^{\text{an}}$, we write $|f|(v) := e^{-v(f)}$. When $\sigma = \{0\}$, X_σ^{an} is the NA analytic torus $\mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$. Endowed with the Berkovich topology, X^{an} is a compact Hausdorff space. There is a kernel map $X^{\text{an}} \rightarrow X$ and a center map $X^{\text{an}} \rightarrow X$, which are continuous and anti-continuous respectively.

The *tropicalization* of X^{an} is a topological space N_P that is homeomorphic to P and contains $N_{\mathbb{R}}$ as an open dense subset, see [BPS14, §4.1]. There are two continuous maps

$$\varrho : X^{\text{an}} \rightarrow N_P, \quad \vartheta : N_P \rightarrow X^{\text{an}}$$

called the tropicalization and the Gauss section respectively. We only give their definitions on $\mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$ and $N_{\mathbb{R}}$. For $v \in \mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$, i.e. a semivaluation on $\mathbb{C}[M]$, $\varrho(v) \in N_{\mathbb{R}}$ is defined as

$$\varrho(v) : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad m \mapsto -v(x^m).$$

Note that $v(x^m)$ must be finite since $v(x^m) + v(x^{-m}) = v(1) = 0$.

For the Gauss section, given a $y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}$, $\vartheta_y := \vartheta(y) \in \mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$ is defined by

$$\vartheta_y \left(\sum_{m \in M} c_m x^m \right) = \min_{c_m \neq 0} \langle m, -y \rangle, \quad \text{if } \exists c_m \neq 0.$$

It is a valuation on the function field of X . For instance, $\vartheta(0) = v_{tr}$ the trivial valuation. Moreover, the center of ϑ_y is the generic point of toric subvariety $V(\sigma_{-y})$, where $\sigma_{-y} \in \mathcal{F}_P$ is the minimal cone containing $-y$.

The image of ϑ is called the skeleton of X^{an} , denoted by $\text{Sk}(X^{\text{an}})$. We have $\varrho \circ \vartheta = \text{Id}$, so $\mathcal{R} := \vartheta \circ \varrho$ is a retraction to the skeleton. For $v \in \mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$, we have

$$(\mathcal{R}v) \left(\sum_{m \in M} c_m \mathbf{x}^m \right) = \min_{c_m \neq 0} v(\mathbf{x}^m) \leq v \left(\sum_{m \in M} c_m \mathbf{x}^m \right). \quad (2.5)$$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathbb{T}^{\text{an}} & \xrightarrow{\quad} & X^{\text{an}} & \xrightarrow{\quad \mathcal{R} \quad} & \text{Sk}(X^{\text{an}}) \\ \varrho \downarrow & & \varrho \downarrow & \nearrow \vartheta & \\ N_{\mathbb{R}} & \xrightarrow{\text{dense}} & N_P & & \end{array}$$

Remark 7. Although $\mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$ has no usual group structure, one can define a multi-valued product and an action on X^{an} , refer to [BPS14, §4.2]. The NA compact torus $\mathbb{S}^{\text{an}} \subset \mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$ is the subset of semivaluations such that $v(\mathbf{x}^m) = 0$ for all $m \in M$. Then the tropicalization N_P is the quotient space of X^{an} modulo the action of $\mathbb{S}^{\text{an}}$. In the Archimedean setting, N_P is the quotient space of $X(\mathbb{C})$ modulo the action of $T_{\mathbb{R}}$. So in both settings, N_P is the common stage for toric reduction.

2.4. Toric metrics. Let L^{an} be the analytification of L . Since the base field $\mathbb{C}$ is trivially normed, there is a canonical metric on L^{an} called the trivial metric. Regarding the trivial metric, the norm function of a section $s \in R_k$ is $|s|_{tr}(v) := e^{-v(s)}$. When v is a divisorial valuation, $v(s)$ is just the vanishing order of s along the divisor. Any metric on L^{an} is represented by a function $\varphi : X^{\text{an}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty\}$. With respect to metric φ , the norm of $s \in R_k$ is $|s|_{\varphi} := |s|_{tr} e^{-k\varphi}$.

A Fubini–Study metric φ on L^{an} is defined to have the form

$$\varphi = \frac{1}{m} \max_j \{ \log |s_j|_{tr} + \lambda_j \},$$

where $m \geq 1$, $\lambda_j \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\{s_j\} \subset R_m$ are finitely many sections without common zero. A psh metric φ (not $\equiv -\infty$) on L^{an} is defined to be the pointwise limit of a decreasing sequence of Fubini–Study metrics. Denote by $\text{PSH}^{\text{NA}}(L)$ the set of psh metrics, and $\text{CPSH}^{\text{NA}}(L)$ the set of continuous psh metrics. We may omit “ L ” when it is fixed.

Definition 8. Suppose that (X, L) is a polarized variety and kL is globally generated. The NA Fubini–Study map $\text{FS}_k : \mathcal{N}(R_k) \rightarrow \text{CPSH}^{\text{NA}}(L)$ is defined by

$$\text{FS}_k(\chi) := \frac{1}{k} \sup_{s \in R_k \setminus \{0\}} \{ \log |s|_{tr} + \chi(s) \} = \frac{1}{k} \max_{1 \leq j \leq N_k} \{ \log |s_j|_{tr} + \chi(s_j) \}, \quad (2.6)$$

where (s_j) is any basis diagonalizing χ .

When (X, L) is the toric variety associated to lattice polytope P , kL is always globally generated. If χ is $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant, then $\text{FS}_k(\chi)$ is torus-invariant in the following sense.

Definition 9. Let (X, L) be the toric variety associated to a lattice polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$.

(1) For any $U \subset N_P$, function $\varphi : \varrho^{-1}(U) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is *torus-invariant* if $\mathcal{R}^* \varphi = \varphi$, i.e. φ is constant along the fibers of tropicalization map. Let $\text{PSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L)$ ($\text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L)$) be the space of torus-invariant (continuous) psh metrics on L^{an} .

(2) For a torus-invariant metric φ on L^{an} , its tropical potential $F_{\varphi} : N_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is defined as

$$F_{\varphi}(y) := -\log |s_D|_{\varphi}(\vartheta_y) = \vartheta_y(s_D) + \varphi(\vartheta_y) = F_P(y) + \varphi(\vartheta_y). \quad (2.7)$$

The last = is due to Proposition 10 (1) below, and $F_P(y) := \max_{u \in P} \langle u, y \rangle$ is the support function of P .

For instance, as the functions on $\mathbb{T}^{\text{an}}$, $v \mapsto v(x^m)$ and $|s_D|_{tr}$ are torus-invariant. Thus for $\forall u \in P_k$, the norm function $|s_{u,k}|_{tr} = |x^{ku}| |s_D|_{tr}^k$ is torus-invariant. For any $\chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$, since it is diagonalized by $(s_{u,k})$, $\text{FS}_k(\chi)$ is torus-invariant.

Proposition 10. (1) For any $y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}$, we have $\vartheta_y(s_D) = F_P(y) := \max_{u \in P} \langle u, y \rangle$.

(2) Let $\chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ given by $f : P_k \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $\chi(s_{u,k}) = -kf(u)$. The tropical potential for $\text{FS}_k(\chi)$ is

$$F(y) = \max_{u \in P_k} \{ \langle u, y \rangle - f(u) \}, \quad \forall y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}. \quad (2.8)$$

Proof. (1) Take a full-dimensional cone $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}_P$ containing $-y$. Let m_σ be the corresponding vertex of P , then we have $\langle m_\sigma, y \rangle = \max_{u \in P} \langle u, y \rangle = F_P(y)$. Note that X_σ contains the center of valuation ϑ_y , and $s_\sigma := x^{m_\sigma} s_D$ (2.2) is a frame of L over X_σ . We represent $s_D = x^{-m_\sigma} s_\sigma$. By the definition of $\vartheta_y(s_D)$, we have

$$\vartheta_y(s_D) = \vartheta_y(x^{-m_\sigma} s_\sigma) = \langle m_\sigma, y \rangle = F_P(y).$$

(2) Since χ is diagonalized by $\{s_{u,k} := x^{ku} s_D^k \mid u \in P_k\}$, we have

$$\text{FS}_k(\chi) = \max_{u \in P_k} \{ k^{-1} \log |s_{u,k}|_{tr} - f(u) \}.$$

By (1), we have $\log |s_{u,k}|_{tr} (\vartheta_y) = -\vartheta_y(s_{u,k}) = \langle ku, y \rangle - kF_P(y)$. Put it into the definition (2.7), then (2.8) follows. $\square$

To capture the behavior of tropical potentials at infinity, we consider their Legendre transforms. The Legendre transform of a function $F : N_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is defined as

$$F^*(x) = \sup_{y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} \{ \langle x, y \rangle - F(y) \} : M_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\}.$$

Conversely, the Legendre transform of $\phi : M_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\}$ ($\not\equiv +\infty$) is defined as

$$\phi^*(y) = \sup_{x \in M_{\mathbb{R}}} \{ \langle x, y \rangle - \phi(x) \} : N_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\}.$$

Let $\mathcal{C}(P)$ be the space of convex functions on P which are continuous up to the boundary. We have a bijection

$$\{ \text{convex } F : N_{\mathbb{R}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid |F - F_P| \leq C \} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{C}(P), \quad F \mapsto F^*.$$

Since for any F in the LHS, F^* is a finite-valued lsc convex function on P . By [GKR68], F^* is also upper semicontinuous, thus $F^* \in \mathcal{C}(P)$.

Theorem 11 ([BPS14, Theorem 4.8.1]). Let (X, L) be the toric variety given by a lattice polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$. Then the map

$$\text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(P), \quad \varphi \mapsto (F_\varphi)^* \quad (2.9)$$

is a bijection, where F_φ (2.7) is the tropical potential of φ .

For any $\chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ given by $f : P_k \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, we define $f(x) = +\infty$ for $x \notin P_k$, then (2.8) is just f^* . Hence the Legendre transform of the tropical potential of $\text{FS}_k(\chi)$ is $(f^*)^*$, which is the convex envelope of f , i.e.

$$f^\vee(x) := \sup \{ \eta(x) \mid \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P), \eta \leq f \text{ on } P_k \}, \quad \text{for } x \in P. \quad (2.10)$$

Obviously, $f^\vee$ is a piecewise affine convex function over P . For any affine function h , we have $(f + h|_{P_k})^\vee = f^\vee + h$. For any $f_1, f_2 \in \mathbb{R}^{P_k}$, we have

$$(f_1 + f_2)^\vee \geq f_1^\vee + f_2^\vee.$$

In a summary, under (2.4) and (2.9), Fubini–Study map $\text{FS}_k : \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T \rightarrow \text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L)$ is identified with the convex envelope map

$$\vee : \mathbb{R}^{P_k} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(P), \quad f \mapsto f^\vee. \quad (2.11)$$

2.5. The super-norm map. The super-norm map is introduced in [BE21; BJ18], which plays the role of the Hilbert map in the Archimedean geometric quantization picture.

Definition 12. Let (X, L) be a polarized variety. Denote by $\mathcal{L}^\infty$ the space of bounded functions on X^{an} . The super-norm map $\text{SN}_k : \mathcal{L}^\infty \rightarrow \mathcal{N}(R_k)$ is defined as

$$\text{SN}_k(\varphi)(s) := -\log \left(\sup_{X^{\text{an}}} |s|_{tr} e^{-k\varphi} \right) = \inf_{v \in X^{\text{an}}} \{v(s) + k\varphi(v)\}. \quad (2.12)$$

In the toric setting, we show the super-norms induced by torus-invariant metrics are $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant.

Proposition 13. (1) Suppose that metric φ is torus-invariant, then for any $s \in R_k$ and $v \in X^{\text{an}}$ we have $|s|_\varphi(v) \leq |s|_\varphi(\mathcal{R}v)$, where $\mathcal{R} : X^{\text{an}} \rightarrow \text{Sk}(X^{\text{an}})$ is (2.5). This implies

$$\sup_{X^{\text{an}}} |s|_\varphi = \sup_{\text{Sk}(X^{\text{an}})} |s|_\varphi. \quad (2.13)$$

(2) If bounded metric φ is torus-invariant, then the induced super-norm $\text{SN}_k(\varphi)$ is $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant.

Proof. (1) By (2.5) and $\varphi(v) = \varphi(\mathcal{R}v)$ for any $v \in X^{\text{an}}$, we have

$$|s|_\varphi(v) = |s|_{tr}(v) e^{-k\varphi(v)} \leq |s|_{tr}(\mathcal{R}v) e^{-k\varphi(\mathcal{R}v)} = |s|_\varphi(\mathcal{R}v).$$

(2) By (2.13), we only need to show that $|t \cdot s|_\varphi(v) = |s|_\varphi(v)$ for any $t \in T_{\mathbb{C}}$, $s \in R_k$ and $v \in \text{Sk}(X^{\text{an}})$. It amounts to show $v(t \cdot s) = v(s)$. Let $s = \sum_{u \in P_k} c_u s_{u,k}$, then $t \cdot s = \sum c_u t^{-ku} s_{u,k}$, where $t^{-ku} := x^{-ku}(t) \in \mathbb{C}^*$. Take a maximal affine open set X_σ containing the center of v , and represent $s_{u,k} = x^{ku-km_\sigma} s_\sigma^k$ by the local frame s_σ of L , then we have

$$v(t \cdot s) = v \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} c_u t^{-ku} x^{ku-km_\sigma} \right) = \min_{c_u \neq 0} v(x^{ku-km_\sigma}) = v(s),$$

where the second = is due to $\mathcal{R}v = v$ and (2.5). $\square$

By the above proposition, the super-norms induced by invariant metrics are determined by their values on eigen-sections $s_{u,k}$.

Proposition 14. Assume that $\varphi : X^{\text{an}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is torus-invariant, bounded and upper semi-continuous, then we have $\text{SN}_k(\varphi)(s_{u,k}) = -kF_\varphi^*(u)$ for all $k \geq 1$ and $u \in P_k$, where F_φ^* is the Legendre transform of the tropical potential F_φ of φ .

Proof. For $s \in R_k$, the function $v \mapsto |s|_\varphi = e^{-v(s)-k\varphi(v)}$ is lsc on X^{an} , and $T^{\text{an}} \subset X^{\text{an}}$ is dense, so we have $\sup_{X^{\text{an}}} |s|_\varphi = \sup_{T^{\text{an}}} |s|_\varphi$. By Proposition 13 (1), it suffices to take the supremum over the skeleton, so $\sup_{T^{\text{an}}} |s|_\varphi = \sup_{y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} |s|_\varphi(\vartheta_y)$. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} \text{SN}_k(\varphi)(s_{u,k}) &= \inf_{y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} \{ \vartheta_y(s_{u,k}) + k\varphi(\vartheta_y) \} = \inf_{y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} \{ \vartheta_y(x^{ku}) + \vartheta_y(s_D^k) + k\varphi(\vartheta_y) \} \\ &= k \inf_{y \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} \{ F_\varphi(y) - \langle u, y \rangle \} = -kF_\varphi^*(u), \end{aligned}$$

where in the second row we used $\vartheta_y(s_D) = F_P(y)$ (Proposition 10) and (2.7). $\square$

In a summary, under (2.4) and (2.9), super-norm map $\text{SN}_k : \text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L) \rightarrow \mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ is identified with the restriction map

$$\mathcal{C}(P) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{P_k}, \quad \eta \mapsto \eta|_{P_k}.$$

2.6. Asymptotics of the volumes of super-norms. Let (X, L) be a polarized variety. A NA norm χ on R_k corresponds to a filtration $F_\chi^\lambda = \{s \in R_k \mid \chi(s) \geq \lambda\}$ with jumping numbers:

$$\lambda_i(\chi) := \max\{\lambda \mid \dim F_\chi^\lambda \geq i\}, \quad 1 \leq i \leq N_k := \dim R_k.$$

If $\{s_i\} \subset R_k$ is a basis diagonalizing χ , then $\lambda_1 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_{N_k}$ is the re-arrangement of $(\chi(s_i))_i$.

The volume of χ is defined as

$$E_k(\chi) := \frac{1}{kN_k} \sum_{i=1}^{N_k} \lambda_i(\chi). \quad (2.14)$$

For $\varphi \in \text{CPSH}^{\text{NA}}(L)$, Boucksom–Eriksson [BE21, Theorem A] gives the leading term of volume asymptotics, that is

$$E_k(\text{SN}_k(\varphi)) = \mathbb{E}(\varphi) + o(1), \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow \infty, \quad (2.15)$$

where $\mathbb{E}(\varphi)$ is the NA Monge–Ampère energy. The next-order term is expected to be the NA K-energy, which is readily verified when φ is induced by an ample test-configuration, see [Yao25b, Theorem 46].

Suppose that (X, L) is the polarized toric variety given by lattice polytope P , and $\varphi \in \text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L)$ with tropical potential F_φ . By Proposition 14, we have

$$E_k(\text{SN}_k(\varphi)) = -\frac{1}{|P_k|} \sum_{u \in P_k} F_\varphi^*(u).$$

Since F_φ^* is a continuous convex function over P , by the asymptotics of Riemann sum (A.2), we obtain

$$E_k(\text{SN}_k(\varphi)) = -\frac{1}{V_P} \int_P F_\varphi^* dx - \frac{1}{2V_P k} \mathbb{M}_P(F_\varphi^*),$$

where

$$\mathbb{M}_P(\eta) := \int_{\partial P} \eta d\sigma - \int_P \eta \bar{S} dx, \quad \bar{S} := \frac{V_{\partial P, d\sigma}}{V_P}$$

is the toric NA K-energy, see §4.1 for more. Compare with (2.15), we obtain

$$\mathbb{E}(\varphi) = -\frac{1}{V_P} \int_P F_\varphi^* dx, \quad \forall \varphi \in \text{CPSH}_T^{\text{NA}}(L). \quad (2.16)$$

3. MAXIMUM CHOW-DESTABILIZERS AND SECONDARY POLYTOPES

In this section, we show that the maximal Chow-destabilizer of toric variety (X_P, L_P) is determined by the shortest GKZ vector, which is the least norm point on the secondary polytope associated to point set P_k .

3.1. Toric reduction of the maximal Chow-destabilizers. By the torus symmetry, the minimization problem for Chow-weights can be reduced into a convex optimization problem.

Given a polarized variety (X, L) , suppose k is large enough such that $\iota_k : X \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}R_k^*$ is an embedding. Then we can talk about the Chow-stability of $\iota_k(X)$ in the sense of GIT, see [Yao25b, §4.1] for a recap of Chow-stability.

Chow-stability is usually defined via the Chow-weights assigned to the 1-ps of $\text{SL}(R_k)$. The 1-ps with minimum normalized Chow-weight can differ from each other by conjugations. To eliminate this ambiguity, [Yao25b] replace 1-ps by the NA norms on R_k . Then Chow-weight turns into a functional M_k on $\mathcal{N}(R_k)$ which has a NA expression (see [Yao25b, Theorem 3])

$$M_k(\chi) = \mathbb{E}(\text{FS}_k(\chi)) - E_k(\chi), \quad \forall \chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k). \quad (3.1)$$

We focus on the *Chow-unstable* case, i.e. $\inf M_k < 0$. Since M_k is homogeneous, we consider the normalized Chow-weight:

$$\bar{M}_k(\chi) := \frac{M_k(\chi)}{\|\chi\|_2}, \text{ for } \chi \in \mathcal{N}(R_k) \setminus \{\chi_{tr}\}, \text{ where } \|\chi\|_2^2 := \frac{1}{N_k} \sum_{i=1}^{N_k} \lambda_i^2(\chi).$$

By [Yao25b, Theorem 1], in the unstable case, $\bar{M}_k$ admits a unique (modulo scaling) minimizer χ_k^* , which is called the maximal Chow-destabilizer for $\iota_k(X)$. Moreover, uniqueness implies that χ_k^* inherits all symmetries of (X, L) , see [Yao25b, Corollary 2].

Let (X, L) be the toric variety given by lattice polytope P . When $k \geq n - 1$, ι_k is an embedding. Suppose $\iota_k(X)$ is Chow-unstable, by the symmetry principle mentioned above, the maximal Chow-destabilizer is $T_{\mathbb{C}}$ -invariant. Hence, to determine it, it suffices to minimize $\bar{M}_k$ over $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$. Under identification $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T \cong \mathbb{R}^{P_k}$ and (2.11), and use (2.16), we see that Chow-weight (3.1) is identified with

$$M_{P_k} : \mathbb{R}^{P_k} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad M_{P_k}(f) := \frac{1}{N_k} \sum_{u \in P_k} f(u) - \frac{1}{V_P} \int_P f^\vee dx. \quad (3.2)$$

The normalized Chow-weight is identified with

$$\bar{M}_{P_k}(f) := \frac{M_{P_k}(f)}{\|f\|_2}, \quad \|f\|_2^2 := \sum_{u \in P_k} f(u)^2. \quad (3.3)$$

The next task is to find the minimizer of $\bar{M}_{P_k}$. We generalize this problem by replacing P_k with a more general point configuration.

3.2. Marked polytopes.

Definition 15. (1) Let V be a n -dimensional real vector space. A *marked polytope* in V is a pair (Q, A) , where $A \subset V$ is a finite subset (mark points) and its convex hull $Q = \text{conv}(A)$ is full-dimensional. Our primary example is (P, P_k) .

(2) For (Q, A) , we define an inner product space

$$\mathbb{R}^A := \{f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}\}, \quad \langle f, g \rangle := \sum_{u \in A} f(u)g(u).$$

The convex envelope map $\vee : \mathbb{R}^A \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(Q)$ is defined as before.

Remark 16. Even if A is not P_k , $\vee$ also relates to the NA Fubini–Study map. Let M be a lattice, and (Q, A) is a marked polytope in $M_{\mathbb{R}}$. Suppose $A = \{m_1, \dots, m_s\} \subset M$, then the Zariski closure of the image of map

$$T_{\mathbb{C}} \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^{s-1}, \quad t \mapsto [x^{m_1}(t) : \dots : x^{m_s}(t)]$$

is a toric variety X_A (may not isomorphic to X_Q). Take the Berkovich analytification of X_A , and consider the Fubini–Study map from the space of invariant NA norms on $\mathbb{C}^a$ to the space of NA metrics on $\mathcal{O}(1)|_{X_A}$, we will arrive at the envelope map $\vee$.

There are several interactive properties between Fubini–Study map and super-norm map, see [BE21, Lemma 7.23] and [Yao25b, Proposition 35]. The following are its toric concretizations.

Proposition 17. *Given a marked polytope (Q, A) .*

(1) For $\forall f \in \mathbb{R}^A$ and $\eta \in \mathcal{C}(Q)$, we have

$$f^\vee|_A \leq f, \quad (\eta|_A)^\vee \geq \eta.$$

(2) Consider the image of operation $\vee$, we have

$$\text{PL}(Q, A) := \{f^\vee \mid f \in \mathbb{R}^A\} = \{\eta \in \mathcal{C}(Q) \mid (\eta|_A)^\vee = \eta\}.$$

Consider the restrictions of convex functions, we have

$$\mathcal{C}(A) := \{\eta|_A \mid \eta \in \mathcal{C}(Q)\} = \{f \in \mathbb{R}^A \mid f^\vee|_A = f\}.$$

(3) We have a bijection $\vee : \mathcal{C}(A) \rightarrow \text{PL}(Q, A)$, whose inverse is the restriction map.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{R}^A & \xrightleftharpoons[\text{restriction}]{\vee} & \mathcal{C}(Q) \\ \cup & & \cup \\ \mathcal{C}(A) & \xleftarrow{1-1} & \text{PL}(Q, A) \end{array}$$

Proof. (1) is obvious. (2) For the first equality, $\supset$ is trivial. For $\forall f \in \mathbb{R}^A$, let $\eta = f^\vee$. By (1) we have $\eta|_A \leq f$, so $(\eta|_A)^\vee \leq f^\vee = \eta$. By (1) we also have $(\eta|_A)^\vee \geq \eta$, hence $(\eta|_A)^\vee = \eta$, so the $\subset$ direction holds. The second equality can be proved similarly. (3) follows from (2). $\square$

Definition 18. For marked polytope (Q, A) , we define the ‘‘Chow-weight’’ functional $M_A : \mathbb{R}^A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$M_A(f) := \frac{1}{|A|} \sum_{u \in A} f(u) - \frac{1}{|Q|_{\text{dx}}} \int_Q f^\vee \, \text{dx}, \quad (3.4)$$

which generalizes (3.2). It is independent of the choices of Lebesgue measure dx . We say (Q, A) is *Chow-semistable* if $M_A(f) \geq 0$ for all $f \in \mathbb{R}^A$. Otherwise, we say (Q, A) is *Chow-unstable*.

Suppose (Q, A) is Chow-unstable, consider the minimization problem:

$$\inf \left\{ \bar{M}_A(f) := \frac{M_A(f)}{\|f\|} \mid 0 \not\equiv f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \right\}. \quad (3.5)$$

We analyze this problem via the secondary polytopes.

3.3. Secondary polytopes. Roughly speaking, the secondary polytope $\Sigma(A)$ associated to a marked polytope (Q, A) is the ‘‘moduli space’’ of polyhedral subdivisions of Q with nodes in A . The main references are [GKZ94, §7] and [DRS10, §5].

Definition 19. Given a n -dimensional marked polytope (Q, A) .

(1) A *subdivision* of (Q, A) is a family $S = \{(Q_i, A_i) \mid i \in I\}$ of n -dimensional marked polytopes such that

- $A_i \subset A$ and $Q = \bigcup_{i \in I} Q_i$.
- $\forall i, j \in I$, $Q_i \cap Q_j$ is empty or a common face of Q_i and Q_j .
- $\forall i, j \in I$, we have $A_i \cap Q_i \cap Q_j = A_j \cap Q_i \cap Q_j$.

Since $Q_i = \text{conv}(A_i)$, we can simply take S as the family $\{A_i \mid i \in I\}$. Subdivision $T = \{A_i \mid i \in I\}$ is called a *triangulation* of (Q, A) if all Q_i are n -simplex and A_i is the vertex set of Q_i .

(2) We say subdivision S *refines* another one S' (denoted as $S \prec S'$, by no means strictly) if each $A_i \in S$ is contained in some $A'_j \in S'$. It defines a partial order on the set of all subdivisions of (Q, A) . The unique maximum is the trivial subdivision $\{A\}$, and the triangulations are the minimum. A subdivision S is called *full* if $\bigcup_{i \in I} A_i = A$, which is equivalent to that $A_i = Q_i \cap A$ for all i .

(3) **Regular subdivisions.** For any $f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, its convex envelope $f^\vee$ induces a subdivision $S(f) = \{A_i \mid i \in I\}$, which is defined as follows. Let $\{Q_i\}_{i \in I}$ be the maximal subpolytopes on which $f^\vee$ is affine, and we set

$$A_i = \{u \in A \cap Q_i \mid f^\vee(u) = f(u)\}. \quad (3.6)$$

Subdivisions of the form $S(f)$ are called *regular*. By [DRS10, Prop. 2.2.4], (Q, A) always admits a regular triangulation. See [GKZ94, page 219] for an irregular triangulation.

A natural way to compute $\int_Q f^\vee dx$ is to refine $S(f)$ by a triangulation T , then integrate $f^\vee$ over each simplex of T . This procedure yields the GKZ vectors.

Definition 20. (1) **Affine interpolation.** Given a triangulation T of (Q, A) and $f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, we can build a function $\Lambda_T(f)$ which is affine over each simplex of T and equals to f at the simplex vertices. Obviously, Λ_T is a linear operator, and by convexity we have

$$\Lambda_T(f) \geq f^\vee, \quad \forall f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}. \quad (3.7)$$

(2) **GKZ (Gelfand–Kapranov–Zelevinsky) vectors.** For a triangulation $T = \{A_i \mid i \in I\}$ of (Q, A) , the attached *GKZ vector* $g_T : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is

$$g_T(u) := \frac{1}{(n+1)|Q|} \sum_{i: u \in \text{vert}(Q_i)} |Q_i|, \quad \text{for } u \in \bigcup_{i \in I} A_i, \quad (3.8)$$

that is the sum of the volumes of simplices with u as a vertex. If $u \in A$ is not used by T , we set $g_T(u) = 0$. Note that $g_T(u)$ is independent of the choices of Lebesgue measure. The normalization factor is different from [GKZ94], our choice makes $\sum_{u \in A} g_T(u) = 1$.

Proposition 21. For any triangulation T of (Q, A) and $f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, we have

- (1) $\int_Q \Lambda_T(f) = \langle f, g_T \rangle$.
- (2) $\int_Q f^\vee = \langle f, g_T \rangle \Leftrightarrow f^\vee = \Lambda_T(f) \Leftrightarrow T \prec S(f)$.
- (3) Let T go over all triangulations of (Q, A) , we have

$$\int_Q f^\vee = \min_T \langle f, g_T \rangle. \quad (3.9)$$

Proof. (1) Note that the integral of $\Lambda_T(f)$ over a simplex Δ of T is equal to $|\Delta|$ times the average of f over the vertices of Δ . Then take the sum over simplexes, the equality follows. (2) The first $\Leftrightarrow$ follows from (1) and (3.7). Suppose $T \prec S(f)$, this means that for each simplex Δ of T , there is a subpolytope (Q_i, A_i) of $S(f)$ such that $\text{vert}(\Delta) \subset A_i$. By definition (3.6) of $S(f)$, $f^\vee$ is affine over $Q_i \supset \Delta$ and $f^\vee = f$ on A_i , thus $f^\vee = \Lambda_T(f)$ on Δ , so on the whole Q . Conversely, if $f^\vee = \Lambda_T(f)$, then $f^\vee$ is affine over each simplex Δ of T , and $f^\vee = \Lambda_T(f) = f$ at the vertices of Δ , these imply $T \prec S(f)$. (3) $\leq$ follows by (1) and (3.7). On the other hand, there exists a triangulation $T \prec S(f)$, then (2) implies (3.9). $\square$

Definition 22. The secondary polytope associated to a marked polytope (Q, A) is the following convex hull in $\mathbb{R}^A$,

$$\Sigma(A) := \text{conv} \{g_T \in \mathbb{R}^A \mid T \text{ is triangulation of } (Q, A)\}.$$

Immediately, (3.9) implies

$$\int_Q f^\vee = \min_{g \in \Sigma(A)} \langle f, g \rangle, \quad \forall f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}. \quad (3.10)$$

This formula is crucial to solving minimization problem (3.5). Before that, we state the structure theorem of secondary polytopes.

Theorem 23 ([GKZ94, §7 Proposition 1.11 & Theorem 2.4]). *Given a n -dimensional marked polytope (Q, A) .*

(1) *The affine subspace spanned by $\Sigma(A)$ is*

$$\left\{ g \in \mathbb{R}^A \mid \sum_{u \in A} g(u) = 1, \sum_{u \in A} g(u) \cdot \vec{u} = \int_Q \vec{x} \, dx \right\}. \quad (3.11)$$

So $\dim \Sigma(A) = |A| - n - 1$.

(2) (Subdivision-face correspondence) *For a regular subdivision S , we define*

$$F(S) := \text{conv} \{ g_T \in \mathbb{R}^A \mid \text{triangulation } T \prec S \}.$$

Then the map $S \mapsto F(S)$ is an order-preserving bijection from the poset of regular subdivisions of (Q, A) to the face poset of $\Sigma(A)$. The regular triangulations are in one-to-one correspondence with the vertices of $\Sigma(A)$.

(3) *For any $f \in \mathbb{R}^A$, $\langle f, \cdot \rangle|_{\Sigma(A)}$ attains its minimum exactly on face $F(S(f))$. For any regular subdivision S , the outer-normal cone of $F(S)$ is*

$$\{ f \in \mathbb{R}^A \mid \langle f, \cdot \rangle|_{\Sigma(A)} \text{ attains minimum on } F(S) \} = \{ f \in \mathbb{R}^A \mid S(f) \succ S \}.$$

Example 24. Let $A = \{(0, 0), (1, 0), (2, 0), (1, 1), (0, 1)\} \subset \mathbb{R}^2$, $Q = \text{conv}(A)$ is a trapezoid. Its secondary polytope $\Sigma(A)$ is a pentagon.

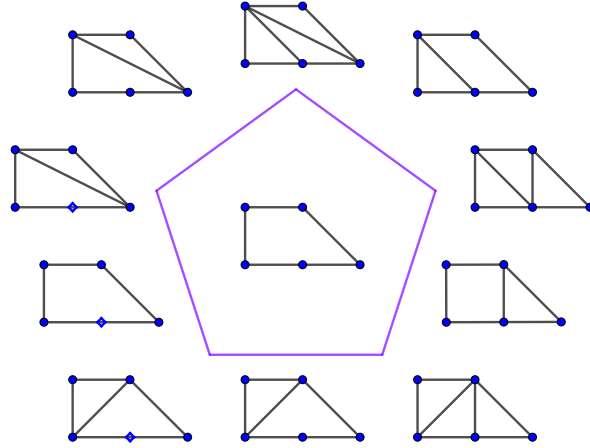


FIGURE 3.1. $\Sigma(A)$ and the corresponding subdivisions.

3.4. Determine Chow-stability by secondary polytopes. Define subspace

$$\mathbb{R}_0^A := \left\{ f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid \sum_{u \in A} f(u) = 0 \right\} \subset \mathbb{R}^A$$

and orthogonal projection

$$\pi : \mathbb{R}^A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_0^A, \quad \pi(f) = f - \bar{f}, \quad \bar{f} := \frac{1}{|A|} \sum_{u \in A} f(u).$$

By (3.10), we rewrite M_A (3.4) as

$$M_A(f) = - \int_Q (\pi f)^\vee = - \min_{g \in \Sigma(A)} \langle \pi f, g \rangle = - \min_{h \in \pi(\Sigma(A))} \langle f, h \rangle. \quad (3.12)$$

The last equality used $\langle \pi f, g \rangle = \langle f, \pi g \rangle$. Now, M_A is almost the support function of $\pi(\Sigma(A))$. By the same trick, we can handle the relative Chow-weights.

Definition 25. Given a n -dimensional marked polytope (Q, A) .

(1) Let $\mathcal{A}$ be the space of affine functions. Since the restriction map $\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^A$ is injective, we can identify $\mathcal{A}$ with the image. Let $R(A) := \mathcal{A}^\perp$ be the orthogonal complement in $\mathbb{R}^A$, that is

$$R(A) = \left\{ f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \mid \sum_{u \in A} f(u) = 0, \sum_{u \in A} f(u) \vec{u} = 0 \right\}.$$

It records the affine relations between the points in A . Let $\Pi : \mathbb{R}^A \rightarrow R(A)$ be the orthogonal projection. By (3.11), the projection image of $\Sigma(A)$ to $\mathcal{A}$ is a single point, denoted by ℓ_A , which is the unique affine function satisfying

$$\oint_Q h = \sum_{u \in A} h(u) \ell_A(u), \quad \forall \text{ affine } h.$$

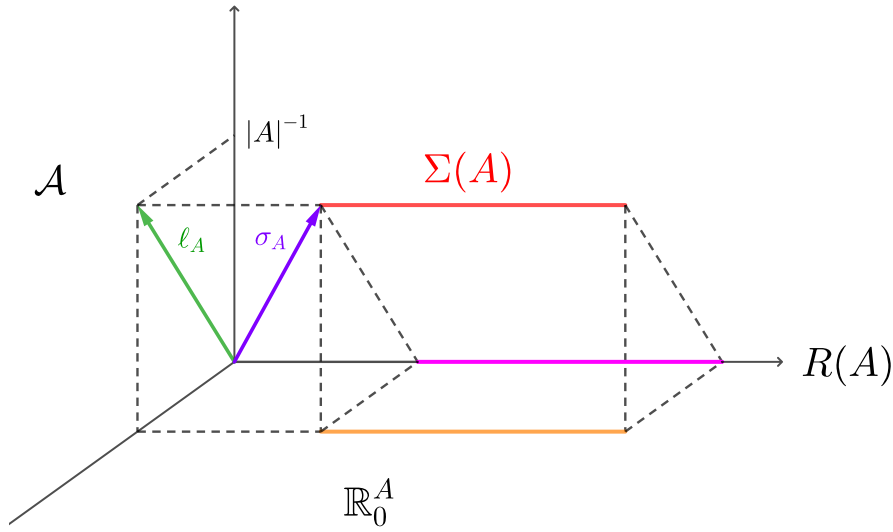


FIGURE 3.2. We only shows the positional relations.

(2) We define the *relative Chow-weight functional* $M_A^{\text{rel}} : \mathbb{R}^A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is

$$M_A^{\text{rel}}(f) := - \oint_Q (\Pi f)^\vee = - \oint_Q f^\vee + \langle f, \ell_A \rangle.$$

It vanishes on affine functions. We say (Q, A) is *relatively Chow-semistable* if $M_A^{\text{rel}}(f) \geq 0$ for all $f \in \mathbb{R}^A$. Otherwise, we call (Q, A) is *relatively Chow-unstable*.

Remark 26. When $(Q, A) = (P, P_k)$ and f takes rational numbers, $M_A^{\text{rel}}(f)$ is the genuinely relative Chow-weight for toric variety $X_P \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}R_k^*$ relative to the automorphism group $T_{\mathbb{C}}$, in the sense of [Sze06]. Note that our “relative Chow-semistability” differs from that in [Ono13, Definition 5.3], which involves the extremal affine function.

By (3.10), we also have support function formula

$$M_A^{\text{rel}}(f) = - \min_{g \in \Sigma(A)} \langle \Pi f, g \rangle = - \min_{h \in \Pi(\Sigma(A))} \langle f, h \rangle. \quad (3.13)$$

A consequence is that the (relative) Chow-semistability is determined by the location of $\Sigma(A)$.

Theorem 27. (1) Marked polytope (Q, A) is Chow-semistable (Definition 18) if and only if the constant function $|A|^{-1} \in \Sigma(A)$, equivalently $\ell_A \equiv |A|^{-1}$. In addition, (Q, A) is relatively Chow-semistable (Definition 25) if and only if $\ell_A \in \Sigma(A)$. Refer to figure 3.3.

(2) For toric variety (X, L) given by a lattice polytope P , the projective embedding $\iota_k(X)$ induced by $|kL|$ is Chow-semistable if and only if $|P_k|^{-1} \in \Sigma(P_k)$, where Chow-semistability is with regard to the whole linear group action.

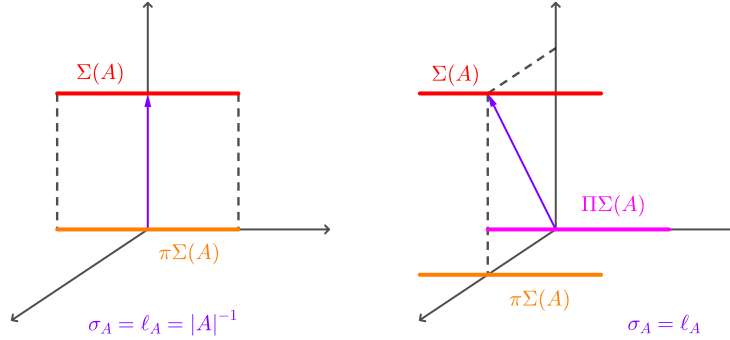


FIGURE 3.3. Left: (Q, A) is Chow-semistable. Right: (Q, A) is Chow-unstable but relatively Chow-semistable. Refer to Figure 3.2.

Proof. (1) follows from (3.12) and (3.13) respectively.

(2) By [Lee+19, Corollary 2.3, 2.7] or [Yao25b, Corollary 25], Chow-semistability is equivalent to the semistability with respect to the action of maximal torus. The latter one is the same as the Chow-semistability of (P, P_k) in the sense of Definition 18. $\square$

Remark 28. If $|P_k|^{-1} \in \Sigma(P_k)$, by (3.11), we obtain a barycenter equality

$$\frac{1}{|P_k|} \sum_{u \in P_k} \vec{u} = \frac{1}{V_P} \int_P \vec{x} \, dx.$$

This is a necessary condition for $X_P \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}R_k^*$ being Chow-semistable, which was discovered by Ono [Ono11]. Hence Chow-semistability is a very stringent property for toric varieties. In contrast, relative Chow-semistability is far easier to satisfy.

Example 29. Marked polytope (Q, A) in Example 24 is relatively Chow-semistable, since

$$\ell_A = \left(\frac{5}{27}, \frac{5}{27}, \frac{5}{27}, \frac{2}{9}, \frac{2}{9} \right) \in \Sigma(A),$$

which is the restriction of affine function $h(x, y) = \frac{1}{27}(y + 5)$.

3.5. Minimize the normalized Chow-weights. Suppose (Q, A) is Chow-unstable, we determine the minimizers of $\bar{M}_A$ (3.5). It follows from the basic fact below.

Lemma 30. Let K be a compact convex subset in an inner-product space W . Suppose $0 \notin K$, let $x^* \in K$ be the unique point on K with minimal norm.

(1) $\langle x^*, x \rangle \geq \langle x^*, x^* \rangle$ for all $x \in K$. Moreover, x^* is the unique point on K satisfying this property.

(2) Let $H(x) = \min_{y \in K} \langle x, y \rangle$, then we have

$$\max_{x \in W \setminus \{0\}} \frac{H(x)}{\|x\|} = \min_{y \in K} \|y\| = \|x^*\|. \quad (3.14)$$

The maximizers for the left-hand side are $\{ax^* \mid a > 0\}$.

Proof. (1) For any $x \in K$, let $x_t := tx + (1-t)x^* \in K$ for $t \in [0, 1]$. Since x^* has minimal norm, we have

$$0 \leq \frac{d}{dt} \|x_t\|^2 \big|_{t=0} = 2 \langle x - x^*, x^* \rangle.$$

Conversely, if $y \in K$ satisfies this condition. It implies $\|y\|^2 \leq \langle y, x^* \rangle \leq \|y\| \|x^*\|$, so $\|y\| \leq \|x^*\|$. Since the minimal-norm point is unique, we have $y = x^*$.

(2) For any $x \in W \setminus \{0\}$ and $y \in K$, Cauchy–Schwarz inequality $\langle x, y \rangle \leq \|x\| \|y\|$ implies

$$\frac{\langle x, y \rangle}{\|x\|} \leq \|y\|.$$

Take $\inf_{y \in K}$ on both sides, we obtain $\frac{H(x)}{\|x\|} \leq \min_{y \in K} \|y\| = \|x^*\|$. Hence $\leq$ side of (3.14) follows. On the other hand, by (1), we have

$$\frac{H(x^*)}{\|x^*\|} = \frac{\min_{y \in K} \langle x^*, y \rangle}{\|x^*\|} = \frac{\langle x^*, x^* \rangle}{\|x^*\|} = \|x^*\|.$$

Hence (3.14) holds and x^* is a maximizer of $\bar{H}(x) := H(x)/\|x\|$.

Uniqueness. Suppose x_0, x_1 are both maximizers for $\bar{H}$. Scaling them such that $\|x_0\| = \|x_1\| = 1$, then $H(x_0) = H(x_1) = \max \bar{H} > 0$. Consider $x_m = (x_0 + x_1)/2 \neq 0$. If $x_0 \neq x_1$, then we have $\|x_m\| < 1$. Since H is concave,

$$H(x_m) \geq \frac{1}{2} (H(x_0) + H(x_1)) = \max \bar{H}.$$

This follows that

$$\bar{H}(x_m) = \frac{H(x_m)}{\|x_m\|} \geq \frac{\max \bar{H}}{\|x_m\|} > \max \bar{H}.$$

That is absurd, so $x_0 = x_1$. □

Definition 31 (shortest GKZ vector). For a marked polytope (Q, A) , since $0 \notin \Sigma(A)$, we define the *shortest GKZ vector* $\sigma_A \in \Sigma(A)$ is the unique least-norm point on $\Sigma(A)$. By the subdivision-face correspondence (Theorem 23), there is a unique regular subdivision S_A of (Q, A) such that $F(S_A)$ is the minimal face containing σ_A . Refer to figure 3.2.

Remark 32. Note that σ_A may not be a vertex of $\Sigma(A)$ (i.e. S_A is not a triangulation). In that case, σ_A is a convex combination of GKZ vectors. See §3.7 for an example.

Now, we determine the maximal Chow-destabilizers by shortest GKZ vectors.

Theorem 33. Suppose marked polytope (Q, A) is Chow-unstable (i.e. $\inf M_A < 0$), then we have

$$\min \left\{ \frac{M_A(f)}{\|f\|} \mid 0 \neq f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \right\} = - \|\sigma_A - |A|^{-1}\|.$$

The minimizers are $a(\sigma_A - |A|^{-1})$, $\forall a > 0$. Applying to the case $(Q, A) = (P, P_k)$, we obtain the part (2) of Theorem 2.

Proof. Apply Lemma 30 to the formula (3.12) of M_A . Take $K = \pi(\Sigma(A))$ and the least-norm point is $\sigma_A - |A|^{-1}$.

For part (2) of Theorem 2. Suppose (X, L) is the toric variety induced by P and $\iota_k(X)$ is Chow-unstable. By the symmetry principle [Yao25b, Corollary 2], the minimizers of (1.3) belong to $\mathcal{N}(R_k)^T$ over which the Chow-weight has formula (3.3). Then the statement follows. □

3.6. Properties of shortest GKZ vectors. We establish two properties of σ_A , the convexity and positivity.

Theorem 34. Let $\sigma_A : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the shortest GKZ vector associated to marked polytope (Q, A) , then $\sigma_A^\vee|_A = \sigma_A$, which means that σ_A is convex.

Proof. Consider functional:

$$H(f) := \int_Q f^\vee = \min_{g \in \Sigma(A)} \langle f, g \rangle, \quad f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}.$$

By Lemma 30, maximizers of $\bar{H}(f) := H(f)/\|f\|$ are $a\sigma_A$, $\forall a > 0$.

Let $\rho := \sigma_A^\vee|_A$, we have $0 \leq \rho \leq \sigma_A$, thus $\|\rho\| \leq \|\sigma_A\|$. By Proposition 17 (2), we have $\rho^\vee = \sigma_A^\vee$. These imply

$$\frac{H(\rho)}{\|\rho\|} = \frac{H(\sigma_A)}{\|\rho\|} \geq \frac{H(\sigma_A)}{\|\sigma_A\|}.$$

Hence ρ is also a maximizer of $\bar{H}$. We have $\rho = a\sigma_A$ for some $a > 0$. But $\rho^\vee = \sigma_A^\vee$ implies $a = 1$, so $\rho = \sigma_A$. $\square$

It is obvious that $\sigma_A \geq 0$ from its definition, further we can show that $\sigma_A > 0$ at every point.

Theorem 35. *Let (Q, A) be a marked polytope.*

(1) *Let S_A be the unique regular subdivision such that $F(S_A)$ is the minimal face of $\Sigma(A)$ containing σ_A , then we have $S(\sigma_A) \succ S_A$. We cannot exclude the possibility that $S(\sigma_A) \neq S_A$. Conversely, if $g \in \Sigma(A)$ satisfies $g \in F(S(g))$, then $g = \sigma_A$.*

(2) *We have $\sigma_A > 0$ at every point in A . Subdivision S_A must be full, so is $S(\sigma_A)$, which implies $\sigma_A^\vee|_A = \sigma_A$.*

Proof. (1) By Lemma 30 (1), function $\langle \sigma_A, \cdot \rangle|_{\Sigma(A)}$ attains its minimum at σ_A , so on the whole face $F(S_A)$, since σ_A is contained in the relative interior of $F(S_A)$. On the other hand, Theorem 23 (3) says that the minimizer set is face $F(S(\sigma_A))$. Hence $F(S(\sigma_A)) \supset F(S_A)$, so $S(\sigma_A) \succ S_A$. For the last statement, $g \in F(S(g))$ implies that $\langle g, \cdot \rangle|_{\Sigma(A)}$ attains its minimum at g , by Lemma 30 (1), we can conclude $g = \sigma_A$.

(2) First we handle a simple case, namely σ_A is a vertex of $\Sigma(A)$, then $\sigma_A = g_T$ for a regular triangulation T and $S_A = T$. By (1), we have $S(\sigma_A) \succ T$. Use Proposition 21 (2), we have

$$\sigma_A^\vee = \Lambda_T(\sigma_A) = \Lambda_T(g_T).$$

By definition of GKZ vector, $g_T > 0$ at every vertex of T , thus $\Lambda_T(g_T) > 0$ on Q , i.e. $\sigma_A^\vee > 0$. Since $\sigma_A \geq \sigma_A^\vee|_A$, it implies $\sigma_A > 0$ at every point.

General case. Since $\sigma_A \in F(S_A)$, there exists triangulations $T_i \prec S_A$ ($1 \leq i \leq p$) such that

$$\sigma_A = \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i g_{T_i}, \quad \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i = 1, \quad \lambda_i > 0.$$

Since $S(\sigma_A) \succ S_A \succ T_j$, by Proposition 21 (2), we have

$$\sigma_A^\vee = \Lambda_{T_j}(\sigma_A), \quad \forall 1 \leq j \leq p.$$

Since operator Λ_{T_j} is linear, for each j we have

$$\Lambda_{T_j}(\sigma_A) = \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i \Lambda_{T_j}(g_{T_i}) \geq \lambda_j \Lambda_{T_j}(g_{T_j}),$$

where we used $\Lambda_{T_j}(g_{T_i}) \geq 0$. Since $\Lambda_{T_j}(g_{T_j}) > 0$ on Q , so $\sigma_A^\vee = \Lambda_{T_j}(\sigma_A) > 0$. Since $\sigma_A \geq \sigma_A^\vee|_A$, we obtain $\sigma_A > 0$ at every point.

Next we show S_A is full. For any $a \in A$, we have $0 < \sigma_A(a) = \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i g_{T_i}(a)$, so there exists j such that $g_{T_j}(a) > 0$. By definition of GKZ vector, it means that a is a vertex of T_j . Since $T_j \prec S_A$, a is also a mark point of S_A , thus S_A is full. Then $S(\sigma_A)$ is also full since $S(\sigma_A) \succ S_A$. $\square$

Remark 36. Notice that $\sigma_A > 0$ indicates to us how complicated σ_A is. Represent $\sigma_A = \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i g_{T_i}$ ($\sum \lambda_i = 1, \lambda_i > 0$) by some triangulations T_i of (Q, A) , then $\sigma_A > 0$ implies that every point in A is a vertex of some T_i . Furthermore, if $\sigma_A = g_T$ is a vertex of $\Sigma(A)$, then T must use all the points in A .

3.7. An example of shortest GKZ vector. Let

$$A = \{(0, 0), (0, 2), (2, 0), (2, 2), (1, 1), (6, 5)\} \subset \mathbb{R}^2, \quad Q = \text{conv}(A).$$

There is a SageMath function [Whi] can output $\Sigma(A)$. It turns out $\Sigma(A)$ is 3-dimensional and has 7 facets, 15 edges and 10 vertices, see its 3Dview. Based on [Whi], we write a code [Yao25a] to compute the shortest GKZ vector σ_A . The result is

$$\sigma_A = \left(\frac{15}{121}, \frac{5}{33}, \frac{493}{3025}, \frac{1511}{9075}, \frac{1318}{9075}, \frac{2267}{9075} \right).$$

It shows that (Q, A) is relatively Chow-unstable, and σ_A lies in the relative interior of a facet. In this example, we have $S(\sigma_A) = S_A$. Figure 3.4 shows subdivision S_A .

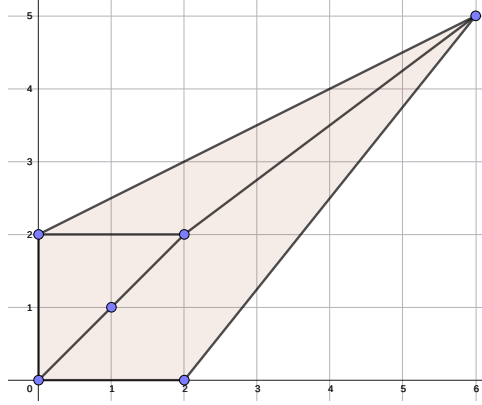


FIGURE 3.4. subdivision $S(\sigma_A) = S_A$

4. OPTIMAL TEST FUNCTIONS FOR K-STABILITY

4.1. Székelyhidi's optimal test function Θ . We recap the optimal test-function for K-unstable toric varieties in [Szé08]. For an introduction to K-stability of toric varieties, refer to [Don02; Szé06; WZ14].

Let $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$ be a lattice polytope. Given a rational piecewise affine convex function η over P , one can build a toric test-configuration for (X_P, L_P) , see [Don02]. Donaldson shows that the attached DF-invariant is equal to

$$\mathbb{M}_P(\eta) := \int_{\partial P} \eta \, d\sigma - \int_P \eta \bar{S} \, dx, \quad \bar{S} = \frac{V_{\partial P, d\sigma}}{V_P},$$

see (A.2) for the definition of $d\sigma$. When η is affine, it recovers the classical Futaki invariant with respect to the automorphism torus action.

Since we focus on the unstable case, we only recall the K-semistability and its relative version. The relative DF-invariant is defined as

$$\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}(\eta) := \int_{\partial P} \eta \, d\sigma - \int_P \eta \ell_P \, dx,$$

where ℓ_P is the unique affine function such that $\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}$ vanishes on all affine functions. Conventionally, ℓ_P is called the *extremal affine function*, since it can give the Hamiltonian function for the extremal vector field.

Definition 37 (K-semistabilities). Given a lattice polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$.

(1) we say P is K-semistable if $\mathbb{M}_P(\eta) \geq 0$ for all $\eta \in \mathcal{C}(P)$. Otherwise, we say P is K-unstable.

(2) we say P is relatively K-semistable if $\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}(\eta) \geq 0$ for all $\eta \in \mathcal{C}(P)$. Otherwise, we say P is relatively K-unstable.

In the K-unstable case, Székelyhidi [Szé08] considered the minimization problem for the normalized invariant

$$\bar{\mathbb{M}}_P(\eta) := \frac{\mathbb{M}_P(\eta)}{\|\eta\|_2}, \quad \|\eta\|_2^2 = \int_P \eta^2,$$

and obtained a minimizer in an enlarged space. Let P^* equals to P excluding all the faces with codimension ≥ 2 , which is also a convex set. Consider space

$$\mathcal{C}_1(P) = \left\{ \eta : P^* \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \text{ continuous convex} \mid \int_{\partial P} \eta \, d\sigma < \infty \right\}. \quad (4.1)$$

Functions in $\mathcal{C}_1(P)$ can be extended to lsc convex functions on the whole P (may take $+\infty$). By [Don02, Lemma 5.1.3], they are integrable over P , thus $\mathbb{M}_P$ is well-defined on $\mathcal{C}_1(P)$.

Theorem 38 ([Szé08]). Given a lattice polytope $P \subset M_{\mathbb{R}}$.

(1) Suppose P is K-unstable, then

$$\inf \{ \bar{\mathbb{M}}_P(\eta) \mid 0 \neq \eta \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P) \} = - \|\Theta_P - \bar{S}\|_2$$

admits a unique (up to scaling) minimizer $\bar{S} - \Theta_P \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P)$. We call concave function Θ_P the optimal test-function for P (denoted by B in [Szé08]), which satisfies

$$\int_{\partial P} \eta \geq \int_P \eta \Theta_P, \quad \forall \eta \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P) \text{ and } \int_{\partial P} \Theta_P = \int_P \Theta_P^2. \quad (4.2)$$

When P is K-semistable, we define $\Theta_P = \bar{S}$, above conditions still hold.

When P is relatively K-semistable, we have $\Theta_P = \ell_P$. If P is relatively K-unstable, $\ell_P - \Theta_P$ is the unique minimizer of $\mathbb{M}_P^{\text{rel}}(\eta) / \|\eta\|$.

(2) Consider the space of “scalar curvatures”

$$\mathcal{S}(P) = \left\{ \theta \in L^2(P) \mid \int_{\partial P} \eta \geq \int_P \eta \theta, \quad \forall \eta \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P) \right\}, \quad (4.3)$$

then Θ_P is the unique element in $\mathcal{S}(P)$ with minimal L^2 -norm. Recall that if $u : P \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is the symplectic potential of an invariant Kähler metric, its scalar curvature is $S(u) = -\sum_{i,j} \partial_i \partial_j u^{ij} \in \mathcal{S}(P)$.

(3) Consider the Calabi flow on X_P with invariant initial data, which can be reduced into evolution equation on P :

$$\dot{u}_t = -S(u_t) = \sum_{i,j} \partial_i \partial_j u_t^{ij}.$$

Assume it admits long-time solutions, then $S(u_t) \xrightarrow{L^2} \Theta_P$ as $t \rightarrow \infty$.

(4) (canonical semi-stable decomposition) Assume P is relatively K-unstable and Θ_P is piecewise affine. Let $Q \subset P$ be a maximal subpolytope over which Θ_P is affine, then Q is relatively K-semistable in the following sense:

$$\int_{\partial Q \cap \partial P} \eta \, d\sigma \geq \int_Q \eta \Theta_P \, dx, \quad \forall \eta \in \mathcal{C}(Q). \quad (4.4)$$

Remark 39 (no island). Under the assumptions in (4), we can deduce that each subpolytope Q must have a facet which is entirely contained in ∂P . If not, we have $|\partial Q \cap \partial P|_{d\sigma} = 0$. Take η in (4.4) to be the affine functions extending $\pm\Theta|_Q$, it implies

$$\int_Q \Theta^2 = \int_{\partial Q \cap \partial P} \Theta \, d\sigma = 0.$$

So $\Theta \equiv 0$ on Q . Since Θ is concave, this implies $\Theta \leq 0$ on P , but this contradicts with $\int_P \Theta = V_{\partial P, d\sigma} > 0$, which follows from (4.2).

4.2. More properties of Θ_P . A central question is whether Θ is piecewise affine. The answer is still unknown. A closely related result is Theorem 42. In this section, we give some properties about Θ . First, we re-characterize Θ as the unique minimizer of a simpler convex functional, which is inspired by the work [Ino22] of Inoue.

Proposition 40. *Convex function $-\Theta_P$ is the unique minimizer of functional*

$$\Psi(\eta) := \frac{1}{2} \int_P \eta^2 dx + \int_{\partial P} \eta \, d\sigma, \quad \eta \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P). \quad (4.5)$$

Proof. For any $\eta \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P)$, (4.2) implies

$$\int_{\partial P} \eta \geq \int_P \eta \Theta \geq -\|\eta\|_2 \|\Theta\|_2 \geq -\frac{1}{2} \|\eta\|_2^2 - \frac{1}{2} \|\Theta\|_2^2.$$

Thus $\Psi(\eta) \geq -\frac{1}{2} \|\Theta\|_2^2$. This lower bound is achieved by $\eta = -\Theta$ since $\int_P \Theta^2 = \int_{\partial P} \Theta$. The uniqueness follows from the strict convexity of L^2 -norm. $\square$

Proposition 41. *We have $\sup_P \Theta_P = \sup_{\partial P} \Theta_P > 0$.*

Proof. Set $u = -\Theta$, we show $\inf_P u = \inf_{\partial P} u$. If this is not true, let $m := \inf_P u < \inf_{\partial P} u$. Since $\int_P \Theta = |\partial P|_{d\sigma} > 0$, we know $m < 0$. Take $\delta > 0$ such that $0 > m + \delta < \inf_{\partial P} u$. Consider $u' = \max\{u, m + \delta\}$. Since $u \geq \inf_{\partial P} u > m + \delta$ on ∂P , we have $u' = u$ on ∂P . Then it is easy to see

$$\Psi(u') = \frac{1}{2} \int_P u'^2 + \int_{\partial P} u' < \frac{1}{2} \int_P u^2 + \int_{\partial P} u = \Psi(u).$$

It is absurd since u is a minimizer of Ψ . $\square$

In [LLS23], the authors showed the boundedness of Θ_P . We find that their proof can yield stronger results. For readers' convenience, we reproduce the proof with some simplifications.

Proof of Theorem 1. For readers to make comparisons, we use the same notations as [LLS23, Theorem 6.2]. For example, coordinates on $N_{\mathbb{R}}$ are denoted by x , and ξ for $M_{\mathbb{R}}$.

Translate P such that $0 \in \text{int} P$, then $a_\rho > 0$. Let

$$u := -\Theta_P : P \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\},$$

which is lsc, convex and taking finite values on P^* . We set $u = +\infty$ outside P . Fix any $p^\circ \in \partial u(0)$, let $\ell(\xi) := u(0) + \langle p^\circ, \xi \rangle$ be the attached support function. Define $u^\circ := u - \ell$, we have $u^\circ(\xi) \geq u^\circ(0) = 0$ for $\forall \xi \in P$. Let

$$f^\circ(x) := (u^\circ)^*(x) := \sup_{\xi \in P} \langle x, \xi \rangle - u^\circ(\xi), \quad x \in N_{\mathbb{R}}$$

be the Legendre dual of u° . We also have $f^\circ(x) \geq f^\circ(0) = 0$. Since $0 \in \text{int} P$, there exists a closed ball $B \subset \text{int} P$ centered at 0, then we have

$$I_P \leq u^\circ \leq I_B + \sup_B u^\circ,$$

where I_B is the convex characteristic function of B , i.e. $I_B = 0$ on B and $= +\infty$ otherwise. Taking the Legendre dual, we obtain

$$\sup_{\xi \in P} \langle x, \xi \rangle \geq f^o(x) \geq \sup_{\xi \in B} \langle x, \xi \rangle - \sup_B u^o, \quad x \in N_{\mathbb{R}}.$$

It implies that the sublevel set

$$S_{f^o}(h) := \{x \in N_{\mathbb{R}} \mid f^o(x) \leq h\}$$

is compact and convex.

We introduce the key construction in [LLS23, before Lem. 3.9]. For $h > 0$, we define the *Legendre truncation* of u^o is

$$u_h^o(\xi) := \sup_{x: f^o(x) \leq h} \langle x, \xi \rangle - f^o(x) = ((u^o)^* + I_{S_{f^o}(h)})^*(\xi).$$

It is the tropical analogue of the Fourier truncation. Intuitionally, for $h \gg 1$, u_h^o is the flattening of u over the region with large slope. Since $f^o \geq 0$, it is easy to see

$$\sup_{f^o(x) \leq h} \langle x, \xi \rangle - h \leq u_h^o \leq u^o, \quad \sup_{f^o(x) \leq h} \langle x, \xi \rangle. \quad (4.6)$$

Set

$$u_h := u_h^o + \ell \leq u^o + \ell = u,$$

which is nondecreasing in h . We will show that

$$u_h = u, \text{ on } P \text{ when } h \gg 1.$$

The proof proceeds in many steps. For $h > 0$, let

$$W_h := \partial f^o \{f^o \leq h\} \subset P,$$

which is compact by [Fig17, Lemma A.22], and may not be convex.

(a) We show $u_h^o = u^o$ on W_h . Suppose $\xi \in \partial f^o(x)$ with $f^o(x) \leq h$, then we have

$$u_h^o(\xi) \geq \langle x, \xi \rangle - f^o(x) = u^o(\xi),$$

where the equality is due to $\xi \in \partial f^o(x)$. Since $u_h^o \leq u^o$, it forces $u_h^o(\xi) = u^o(\xi)$.

(b) We show that W_h is a star set, i.e. if $\xi \in W_h$ then $t\xi \in W_h$ for any $t \in [0, 1]$.

Suppose $\xi \in \partial f^o(x)$ with $f^o(x) \leq h$. Take any $x_t \in \partial u^o(t\xi)$, since $t\xi \in \partial f^o(x_t)$, it suffices to show $f^o(x_t) \leq h$. Since $x \in \partial u^o(\xi)$ and $x_t \in \partial u^o(t\xi)$, by the definition of subdifferentials, we have

$$\begin{aligned} u^o(t\xi) &\geq u^o(\xi) + \langle x, t\xi - \xi \rangle, \\ u^o(\xi) &\geq u^o(t\xi) + \langle x_t, \xi - t\xi \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

They imply $\langle x_t, \xi \rangle \leq \langle x, \xi \rangle$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} f^o(x_t) &= \langle x_t, t\xi \rangle - u^o(t\xi) \leq t \langle x, \xi \rangle - u^o(t\xi) \\ &\leq t \langle x, \xi \rangle - [u^o(\xi) + \langle x, t\xi - \xi \rangle] \\ &= \langle x, \xi \rangle - u^o(\xi) = f^o(x) \leq h. \end{aligned}$$

Since W_h is a star set, we can describe it as

$$W_h = \{tq \mid q \in \partial P, 0 \leq t \leq r_h(q) \leq 1\},$$

where $r_h : \partial P \rightarrow [0, 1]$ is a function. Since W_h is closed, $r_h(q)$ is usc in q and nondecreasing in h . We simply write $r_q := r_h(q)$.

(c) We show that $\lim_{h \rightarrow \infty} r_h(q) = 1$ uniformly for $q \in \partial P$.

For any $\varepsilon \in (0, 1)$, let $P_\varepsilon := (1 - \varepsilon)P$. By [Fig17, Lemma A.22], $\partial u^o(P_\varepsilon)$ is a compact set in $N_{\mathbb{R}}$. We claim that

$$P_\varepsilon \subset W_h \text{ when } h > H_\varepsilon := \sup_{\partial u^o(P_\varepsilon)} f^o.$$

For any $\xi \in P_\varepsilon$, take $x \in \partial u^o(\xi) \subset \partial u^o(P_\varepsilon)$, we have $\xi \in \partial f^o(x)$ and $f^o(x) \leq H_\varepsilon$, so $\xi \in W_{h > H_\varepsilon}$. By the definition of $r_h(q)$, we have

$$1 - \varepsilon \leq r_h(q) \leq 1, \quad \forall q \in \partial P$$

when $h > H_\varepsilon$. Hence (c) follows.

(d) For any $q \in \partial P$, u_h^o is affine restricting on the ray $\{tq \mid t \geq r_q := r_h(q)\}$. Explicitly, we have

$$u_h^o(tq) = \frac{t}{r_q} (u^o(r_q q) + h) - h, \text{ for } t \geq r_q.$$

Proof: For any $q \in \partial P$, fix a $t > r_q$. Since $S_{f^o}(h)$ is compact, the supremum

$$u_h^o(tq) := \sup_{x \in S_{f^o}(h)} \langle x, \xi \rangle - f^o(x) = \sup_{x \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} \langle x, tq \rangle - (f^o(x) + I_{S_{f^o}(h)}(x))$$

is attained by some $x^* \in S_{f^o}(h)$, and this occurs if and only if

$$tq \in \partial (f^o + I_{S_{f^o}(h)})(x^*) = \partial f^o(x^*) + \partial I_{S_{f^o}(h)}(x^*). \quad (4.7)$$

The last equality is due to Moreau–Rockafellar theorem.

If x^* does not lie on the boundary of $S_{f^o}(h)$, (4.7) implies $tq \in \partial f^o(x^*) \subset W_h$. That is absurd since $t > r_q$. Hence x^* must lie on the boundary and $f^o(x^*) = h$.

By the definition of subdifferentials, we note that

$$\begin{aligned} \partial I_{S_{f^o}(h)}(x^*) &= \{\xi \mid \langle x - x^*, \xi \rangle \leq 0, \forall x \in S_{f^o}(h)\} \\ &= \{\lambda \eta \mid \lambda \geq 0, \eta \in \partial f^o(x^*)\}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus by (4.7), we can write $tq = \eta_1 + \lambda \eta_2$ with $\eta_i \in \partial f^o(x^*)$ and $\lambda > 0$.

For any $a \geq 1$, we find

$$atq = \eta_1 + (a - 1 + a\lambda) \frac{(a - 1)\eta_1 + a\lambda\eta_2}{a - 1 + a\lambda} \in \partial f^o(x^*) + \partial I_{S_{f^o}(h)}(x^*),$$

where the convexity of $\partial f^o(x^*)$ is used. This inclusion relation implies that the supremum

$$u_h^o(atq) := \sup_{x \in N_{\mathbb{R}}} \langle x, atq \rangle - (f^o(x) + I_{S_{f^o}(h)}(x))$$

is still attained by x^* . So $u_h^o(atq) = \langle x^*, atq \rangle - h$ for all $a \geq 1$. Since t can be arbitrarily close to r_q , (d) follows.

(e) It is ready to show $u = u_h$ for $h \gg 1$. Let

$$v_h := u - u_h = u^o - u_h^o \geq 0.$$

By property (c), for any $q \in \partial P$, the function $[r_q, 1] \ni t \mapsto v_h(tq)$ is convex and vanishes at $t = r_q$ by (a). It implies that this function is nondecreasing, so

$$v_h(tq) \leq v_h(q), \quad \forall t \in [r_q, 1]. \quad (4.8)$$

Note that $v_h(q) < \infty$, when q lies in the relative interior of facets, since $u < +\infty$ on P^* .

To estimate the integrals over P , we decompose $P = \bigcup_{\rho \in \mathcal{F}_P(1)} P_\rho$, where P_ρ is the cone with apex 0 and base F_ρ (facet of P associated to ρ). Consider the map

$$[0, 1] \times F_\rho \rightarrow P_\rho, \quad (t, q) \mapsto tq.$$

One can check that the pullback of Lebesgue measure $d\mu$ along this map is $a_\rho t^{n-1} dt \wedge d\sigma$.

By (a), $v_h(tq) = 0$ when $t \in [0, r_q]$. Use (4.8), we have

$$\int_{P_\rho} v_h d\mu = a_\rho \int_{F_\rho} \int_{r_q}^1 v_h(tq) t^{n-1} dt d\sigma \leq \frac{a_\rho}{n} \int_{F_\rho} (1 - r_q^n) v_h(q) d\sigma.$$

Take the sum over ρ , we obtain

$$0 \leq \int_P v_h d\mu \leq \frac{\max_\rho a_\rho}{n} \left(1 - \inf_{q \in \partial P} r_q^n\right) \int_{\partial P} v_h d\sigma. \quad (4.9)$$

Compare the L^2 -norms,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_P u_h^2 - \int_P u^2 &= \int_P (u_h^o + \ell)^2 - \int_P (u^o + \ell)^2 = \int_P (u_h^o)^2 - \int_P (u^o)^2 - 2 \int_P v_h \ell \\ &\leq 2 \max_P |\ell| \int_P v_h \leq \frac{2}{n} \max_P |\ell| \max_\rho a_\rho \left(1 - \inf_{q \in \partial P} r_q^n\right) \int_{\partial P} v_h d\sigma. \end{aligned}$$

where $\int_P (u_h^o)^2 \leq \int_P (u^o)^2$ is due to $0 \leq u_h^o \leq u^o$.

We obtain a comparison of functional values,

$$\left(\frac{1}{2} \int_P u_h^2 + \int_{\partial P} u_h\right) - \left(\frac{1}{2} \int_P u^2 + \int_{\partial P} u\right) \leq \left[C \left(1 - \inf_{q \in \partial P} r_q^n\right) - 1\right] \int_{\partial P} v_h d\sigma.$$

By (c), we know $\inf_{q \in \partial P} r_q^n \rightarrow 1$. So there exists $h_0 > 0$, when $h > h_0$, the RHS $\leq -\frac{1}{2} \int_{\partial P} v_h$. Since u is a minimizer of (4.5), we must have $\int_{\partial P} v_h d\sigma = 0$ for $h > h_0$. By (4.9), it implies $\int_P v_h = 0$, so $u = u_h$ almost everywhere. Since u is continuous on P^* and u_h is continuous everywhere, so $u = u_h$ on P^* . Note u is also lsc, so

$$u_h = u, \text{ on } P \text{ when } h > h_0.$$

Moreover, by (4.6), we have

$$\partial u(\text{int} P) = \partial u_h(\text{int} P) \subset \partial u_h(M_{\mathbb{R}}) = S_{f^o}(h) + p^o$$

when $h > h_0$. Since $S_{f^o}(h)$ is bounded, so is $\partial u(\text{int} P)$. $\square$

The following property is due to Li and Zhou. They deal with a general problem and assume a smoothness condition (P2) which is not satisfied by Θ_P , but the proof is still valid.

Theorem 42 ([LZ22, Proposition 3.2]). *Convex function $u = -\Theta_P$ satisfies the homogeneous Monge–Ampère equation in the sense of Alexandrov. Precisely, for any compact set $K \subset \text{int} P$, the Lebesgue measure $|\partial u(K)| = 0$.*

5. FROM SHORTEST GKZ VECTORS TO OPTIMAL TEST-FUNCTION

Back to the original question that motivated our research, whether maximal Chow-destabilizers quantize maximal K-destabilizers. For toric varieties, we have seen that it reduces to the relation between Θ_P and the asymptotics of shortest GKZ vectors for (P, P_k) as k tends to infinity.

5.1. Quantum functional Ψ_k . Motivated by the asymptotics of Riemann sums (A.2), we introduce a quantum functional

$$\Psi_k(\eta) := \frac{1}{2k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k} \eta(u)^2 + \frac{2}{k^{n-1}} \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} \eta(u) - k^n \int_P \eta dx \right), \quad \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P).$$

By (A.1), we have

$$\Psi_k(\eta) \rightarrow \Psi(\eta), \quad \forall \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P).$$

Proof of Theorem 4. Step 1. Reduce the minimization problem

$$\inf \{ \Psi_k(\eta) \mid \eta \in \mathcal{C}(P) \} \quad (5.1)$$

to (5.3). For any $\eta \in \mathcal{C}(P)$, let $\eta_k = (\eta|_{P_k})^\vee$. By Proposition 17, we have $\eta_k \geq \eta$ and $\eta_k|_{P_k} = \eta|_{P_k}$, these imply $\Psi_k(\eta_k) \leq \Psi_k(\eta)$ with equality only if $\eta_k = \eta$. Hence problem (5.1) can be reduced to

$$\inf \{ \Psi_k(\eta) \mid \eta \in \text{PL}(P, P_k) \}, \quad (5.2)$$

recall $\text{PL}(P, P_k)$ is the image of envelope map $\vee : \mathbb{R}^{P_k} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(P)$.

By Proposition 17 (3), $\vee : \mathcal{C}(P_k) \rightarrow \text{PL}(P, P_k)$ is a bijection. Hence we can change the domain of (5.2) to $\mathcal{C}(P_k)$. Since for any $f \in \mathcal{C}(P_k)$, we have $f^\vee|_{P_k} = f$, it follows that

$$\Psi_k(f^\vee) = \frac{1}{2k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k} f(u)^2 + \frac{2}{k^{n-1}} \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} f(u) - k^n \int_P f^\vee \right) =: \check{M}_{P_k}(f).$$

By changing the domain, problem (5.2) is equivalent to

$$\inf \left\{ \check{M}_{P_k}(f) \mid f \in \mathcal{C}(P_k) \right\}. \quad (5.3)$$

Step 2. We claim that

$$f^* := 2V_P k^{n+1} \left(\sigma_k - \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \right)$$

is actually the unique minimizer of $\check{M}_{P_k}$ over larger space $\mathbb{R}^{P_k}$. The uniqueness is obvious, since $\check{M}_{P_k}$ is strictly convex.

Once this claim holds, since $f^* \in \mathcal{C}(P_k)$ by Theorem 34 and Proposition 17 (2), it is also the unique minimizer of (5.3). Then trace back the reductions in Step 1, we see $(f^*)^\vee$ is the unique minimizer of Ψ_k , that is (1.4).

Next we verify the above claim. For any $f \in \mathbb{R}^{P_k}$, by (3.10), we have

$$\frac{1}{V_P} \int_P f^\vee = \min_{g \in \Sigma(P_k)} \langle f, g \rangle \leq \langle f, \sigma_k \rangle = \left\langle f, \sigma_k - \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \right\rangle + \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k} f(u),$$

$$\left\langle f, \sigma_k - \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \right\rangle \leq \|f\| \left\| \sigma_k - \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \right\| \leq \frac{1}{4V_P k^{n+1}} \|f\|^2 + V_P k^{n+1} \left\| \sigma_k - \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \right\|^2.$$

Combine these inequalities together, we obtain

$$\check{M}_{P_k}(f) \geq -2V_P^2 k^{n+2} \left\| \sigma_k - \frac{1}{V_P k^n} \right\|^2.$$

Next we check that this lower bound is achieved by f^* . Denote $f^* = a(\sigma_k - c)$ for short, where $a = 2V_P k^{n+1}$ and $c = \frac{1}{V_P k^n}$. Using identities

$$\sum_{u \in P_k} \sigma_k(u) = 1 \text{ and } \int_P \sigma_k^\vee = V_P \|\sigma_k\|^2,$$

we compute

$$\sum_{u \in P_k} f^*(u) - k^n \int_P (f^*)^\vee = a(2 - c|P_k| - c^{-1} \|\sigma_k\|^2) = -\frac{a}{c} \|\sigma_k - c\|^2.$$

Hence

$$\check{M}_{P_k}(f^*) = \frac{a^2}{2k^n} \|\sigma_k - c\|^2 - \frac{2}{k^{n-1}} \frac{a}{c} \|\sigma_k - c\|^2 = -2V_P^2 k^{n+2} \|\sigma_k - c\|^2.$$

□

5.2. Convergence problem. For $f \in \mathcal{C}(P)$, set

$$\|f\|_{k,2}^2 := \frac{1}{k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k} f(u)^2, \quad B_k(f) := \frac{2}{k^{n-1}} \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} f(u) - k^n \int_P f \, dx \right).$$

Thus $\Psi_k(f) = \frac{1}{2} \|f\|_{k,2}^2 + B_k(f)$. We use the following standard compactness form of the convex quadrature lemma. Notice that no control of the values on faces of codimension at least two is assumed.

Lemma 43 (convex quadrature compactness). *There is a constant C_P such that*

$$B_k(f) \geq -C_P \|f\|_{k,2}, \quad \|f\|_{L^2(P)} \leq C_P \|f\|_{k,2} \quad (5.4)$$

for every k and every $f \in \mathcal{C}(P)$. Moreover, suppose that $f_k \in \mathcal{C}(P)$ and $\sup_k \|f_k\|_{k,2} < \infty$. After passing to a subsequence, there is a convex $f \in L^2(P)$ such that $f_k \rightharpoonup f$ weakly in $L^2(P)$ and $f_k \rightarrow f$ locally uniformly on $\text{int}P$. We use the lower semicontinuous extension of f to P and allow its boundary integral to be $+\infty$. For this subsequence,

$$\liminf_{k \rightarrow \infty} \|f_k\|_{k,2}^2 \geq \|f\|_{L^2(P)}^2, \quad \liminf_{k \rightarrow \infty} B_k(f_k) \geq \int_{\partial P} f \, d\sigma. \quad (5.5)$$

If equality holds in the first inequality of (5.5), then $f_k \rightarrow f$ strongly in $L^2(P)$.

Proof. Choose primitive integral defining functions $l_r \geq 0$ for the facets of P , and put $P^\delta = \{l_r \geq \delta \text{ for every } r\}$. Start with a triangulation of P whose vertices are lattice points and use its standard k -fold subdivision. The resulting simplices have diameter $O(k^{-1})$, vertices in P_k , and uniformly bounded overlap. Group them into the lattice layers $\{j/k \leq l_r \leq (j+1)/k\}$. On every lattice segment transversal to a facet, apply the one-dimensional convexity inequality

$$f((1-t)x + ty) \leq (1-t)f(x) + tf(y), \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1.$$

After summing first over a layer and then over the facets, it gives

$$B_k(f) \geq -C_P \|f\|_{k,2}, \quad \int_P f^2 \, dx \leq C_P^2 \|f\|_{k,2}^2.$$

The same layer calculation, with the first m layers retained and then $m \rightarrow \infty$, gives

$$\liminf_{k \rightarrow \infty} B_k(f_k) \geq \sum_{F \text{ facet of } P} \int_F f \, d\sigma_F. \quad (5.6)$$

Here the negative part of the outermost layer is controlled by the next layer by convexity, whereas its positive part can only increase the left-hand side. Intersections of two facets contain $O(k^{n-2})$ lattice points and disappear after division by k^{n-1} . The right-hand side of (5.6) is understood in the extended sense; it is finite whenever the left-hand side is finite.

The preceding L^2 bound and the usual interior estimates for convex functions give, after passing to a subsequence, weak L^2 convergence and locally uniform convergence on $\text{int}P$. On each fixed P^δ , local uniform convergence and ordinary Riemann sums give

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{k^n} \sum_{u \in P_k \cap P^\delta} f_k(u)^2 = \int_{P^\delta} f^2 \, dx.$$

Letting $\delta \downarrow 0$ proves the first inequality in (5.5); (5.6) proves the second one. Finally, apply the same simplicial layer estimate separately to the regions where f_k is positive and negative. Any L^2 mass which is lost in the shrinking boundary layers then produces a strictly positive defect in the first inequality of (5.5). This proves the last assertion. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 5. Put $\psi = -\Theta_P$. By Proposition 40 and Theorem 1, $\psi \in \mathcal{C}(P)$ is the unique minimizer of Ψ . Minimality of ψ_k and (A.2) give

$$\limsup_{k \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_k(\psi_k) \leq \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_k(\psi) = \Psi(\psi) = \inf \Psi. \quad (5.7)$$

On the other hand, (5.4) and Young's inequality imply

$$\Psi_k(f) \geq \frac{1}{2} \|f\|_{k,2}^2 - C_P \|f\|_{k,2} \geq \frac{1}{4} \|f\|_{k,2}^2 - C_P^2.$$

Together with (5.7), this shows that $\sup_k \|\psi_k\|_{k,2} < \infty$.

Step 1. We first prove convergence of the discrete quadratic terms. Set

$$a_k := \|\psi_k\|_{k,2}^2.$$

The preceding coercivity argument shows that $\{a_k\}$ is bounded. Let A be any subsequential limit of $\{a_k\}$, and choose a subsequence $\{k_j\}$ such that

$$\lim_{j \rightarrow \infty} a_{k_j} = A. \quad (5.8)$$

Lemma 43, applied to $\{\psi_{k_j}\}$, provides a further subsequence, still denoted by $\{k_j\}$, and a convex function $u \in L^2(P)$ such that

$$\psi_{k_j} \rightharpoonup u \quad \text{weakly in } L^2(P), \quad \psi_{k_j} \rightarrow u \quad \text{locally uniformly on } \text{int} P.$$

We claim first that $\int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma$ is finite. Indeed, Lemma 43 interprets this integral in the extended sense. If it were $+\infty$, then (5.8) and (5.5) would imply

$$\liminf_{j \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_{k_j}(\psi_{k_j}) \geq \frac{1}{2} A + \int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma = +\infty,$$

contradicting (5.7). Thus $u \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P)$ and $\Psi(u)$ is well-defined.

Since $a_{k_j} \rightarrow A$, the elementary inequality $\liminf (x_j + y_j) \geq \lim x_j + \liminf y_j$ and (5.5) give

$$\begin{aligned} \liminf_{j \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_{k_j}(\psi_{k_j}) &= \liminf_{j \rightarrow \infty} \left(\frac{1}{2} a_{k_j} + B_{k_j}(\psi_{k_j}) \right) \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} A + \liminf_{j \rightarrow \infty} B_{k_j}(\psi_{k_j}) \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} A + \int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} \|u\|_{L^2(P)}^2 + \int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma = \Psi(u). \end{aligned}$$

Here the last inequality uses $A = \lim_j a_{k_j} \geq \|u\|_{L^2(P)}^2$, which is the first inequality in (5.5). Combining this with (5.7) and the minimality of ψ gives the complete chain

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi(\psi) &\geq \limsup_{j \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_{k_j}(\psi_{k_j}) \geq \liminf_{j \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_{k_j}(\psi_{k_j}) \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} A + \int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma \geq \Psi(u) \geq \Psi(\psi). \end{aligned}$$

Hence every inequality in this chain is an equality. In particular, $\Psi(u) = \Psi(\psi)$, so the uniqueness of the minimizer of Ψ implies

$$u = \psi. \quad (5.9)$$

Moreover, the equality chain contains the identity

$$\frac{1}{2} A + \int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma = \Psi(u) = \frac{1}{2} \|u\|_{L^2(P)}^2 + \int_{\partial P} u \, d\sigma.$$

Since the boundary integral is finite, subtracting it from both sides gives

$$A = \|u\|_{L^2(P)}^2 = \|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2.$$

Thus every subsequential limit of the bounded sequence $\{a_k\}$ equals $\|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2$. It follows that the whole sequence converges:

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \|\psi_k\|_{k,2}^2 = \|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2. \quad (5.10)$$

For completeness, if this conclusion failed, there would be an $\varepsilon > 0$ and a subsequence along which $|a_k - \|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2| \geq \varepsilon$. Boundedness would give a further convergent subsequence, whose limit would be a subsequential limit different from $\|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2$, a contradiction.

Step 2. We next prove strong L^2 convergence of the functions. Let $\{\psi_{k_j}\}$ be an arbitrary subsequence. By Lemma 43, after passing to a further subsequence $\{\psi_{k_{j_\ell}}\}$, there is a convex $v \in L^2(P)$ such that

$$\psi_{k_{j_\ell}} \rightharpoonup v \quad \text{weakly in } L^2(P)$$

and the convergence is locally uniform on $\text{int}P$. The boundary integral of v must be finite: otherwise the boundary liminf in (5.5) would contradict (5.7), exactly as in Step 1. Hence $v \in \mathcal{C}_1(P) \cap L^2(P)$.

By (5.10),

$$\lim_{\ell \rightarrow \infty} \left\| \psi_{k_{j_\ell}} \right\|_{k_{j_\ell},2}^2 = \|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2.$$

The quadratic liminf in (5.5) first shows that $\|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2 \geq \|v\|_{L^2(P)}^2$. Using this inequality, the boundary liminf, (5.7), and minimality of ψ , we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi(\psi) &\geq \liminf_{\ell \rightarrow \infty} \Psi_{k_{j_\ell}}(\psi_{k_{j_\ell}}) \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} \|\psi\|_{L^2(P)}^2 + \int_{\partial P} v \, d\sigma \\ &\geq \frac{1}{2} \|v\|_{L^2(P)}^2 + \int_{\partial P} v \, d\sigma = \Psi(v) \geq \Psi(\psi). \end{aligned}$$

Thus equality holds throughout. The uniqueness of the minimizer gives $v = \psi$, and consequently

$$\lim_{\ell \rightarrow \infty} \left\| \psi_{k_{j_\ell}} \right\|_{k_{j_\ell},2}^2 = \|v\|_{L^2(P)}^2.$$

Therefore equality holds in the first liminf inequality of Lemma 43. The last assertion of that lemma yields

$$\psi_{k_{j_\ell}} \longrightarrow \psi \quad \text{strongly in } L^2(P).$$

We have proved that every subsequence of $\{\psi_k\}$ has a further subsequence converging strongly to ψ . This implies convergence of the whole sequence. Indeed, otherwise there would be an $\varepsilon > 0$ and a subsequence $\{\psi_{k_j}\}$ satisfying

$$\|\psi_{k_j} - \psi\|_{L^2(P)} \geq \varepsilon \quad \text{for every } j,$$

but this subsequence would have a further subsequence converging strongly to ψ , which is impossible. Hence

$$\psi_k \longrightarrow \psi = -\Theta_P \quad \text{strongly in } L^2(P). \quad (5.11)$$

Since $\psi = -\Theta_P$, (5.10) is precisely (1.5). Furthermore, (1.4) and (5.11) give

$$\left\| V_P k^n \sigma_k^\vee - 1 + \frac{\Theta_P}{2k} \right\|_{L^2(P)} = \frac{1}{2k} \|\psi_k + \Theta_P\|_{L^2(P)} = o(k^{-1}),$$

which proves (1.6).

Step 3. Finally, assume that $\{\psi_k\}$ is C^0 -precompact. We show that the convergence is uniform. If not, there would be an $\varepsilon > 0$ and a subsequence $\{\psi_{k_j}\}$ such that

$$\|\psi_{k_j} - \psi\|_{C^0(P)} \geq \varepsilon \quad \text{for every } j. \quad (5.12)$$

By C^0 -precompactness, a further subsequence converges uniformly to some $w \in \mathcal{C}(P)$. Uniform convergence implies convergence to w in $L^2(P)$, whereas (5.11) says that the same subsequence converges to ψ in $L^2(P)$. Uniqueness of the L^2 limit gives $w = \psi$ almost everywhere. Both functions are continuous on P , so $w = \psi$ everywhere. The further subsequence therefore converges uniformly to ψ , contradicting (5.12). Thus $\psi_k \rightarrow \psi$ uniformly. Finally,

$$\left\| V_P k^n \sigma_k^\vee - 1 + \frac{\Theta_P}{2k} \right\|_{C^0(P)} = \frac{1}{2k} \|\psi_k + \Theta_P\|_{C^0(P)} = o(k^{-1}),$$

which is (1.7). $\square$

Remark 44. The theorem gives unconditional L^2 convergence but does not control values on lower-dimensional faces. To obtain uniform convergence, we still need to verify the C^0 -precompactness of $\psi_k = 2V_P k^{n+1} \sigma_k^\vee - 2k$.

Step1.

REMAINING QUESTIONS

- (1) Show the sequence ψ_k is uniformly bounded and equicontinuous, thereby upgrading the unconditional L^2 convergence in Theorem 5 to uniform convergence.
- (2) Since Theorem 38 (4) shows that Θ_P induces a semistable decomposition of P , we should investigate the semistability of each piece of the subdivision induced by σ_A .
- (3) Is there a relation between the asymptotics of $\Sigma(P_k)$ and the space $\mathcal{S}(P)$ (4.3) of prescribed scalar curvatures?
- (4) An effective algorithm to compute σ_A without knowing the entire secondary polytope.

APPENDIX A. TWO-TERMS EXPANSION FOR RIEMANN SUM OF CONVEX FUNCTIONS

We establish a folklore expansion of Riemann sum, which is crucial in the proof of Theorem 5.

Theorem 45. *Let $P \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ be a lattice polytope. For any $k \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, set $P_k = P \cap k^{-1}\mathbb{Z}^n$. Let $f_k : P \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a sequence of convex functions (continuous up to ∂P) which uniformly converges to f . Then we have*

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{k^{n-1}} \left(\sum_{u \in P_k} f_k(u) - k^n \int_P f_k \, dx \right) = \frac{1}{2} \int_{\partial P} f \, d\sigma. \quad (A.1)$$

In particular, when $f_k = f$ for all k , we have expansion

$$\sum_{u \in P_k} f(u) = k^n \int_P f \, dx + \frac{k^{n-1}}{2} \int_{\partial P} f \, d\sigma + o(k^{n-1}). \quad (A.2)$$

In the above, dx is the standard Lebesgue measure, and the boundary measure $d\sigma$ is defined as follows. For each facet $F \subset \partial P$ spanning affine subspace $\text{Aff}(F)$, $d\sigma|_F$ is the Lebesgue measure normalized by the lattice $\text{Aff}(F) \cap \mathbb{Z}^n$.

Remark 46. (1) when f is smooth on an open set containing P , (A.2) is just the leading two-terms of the Euler–Maclaurin expansion. There is vast literature discussing it, see [Tat11] and its references. (2) if f is merely continuous, (A.2) may fail even in one dimension (Weierstrass type functions). (3) If f is convex and piece-wisely linear with rational coefficients, (A.2) can be derived from the asymptotics of lattice point counting, see [Don02, Prop. 4.1.3]. In our setting, (A.2) cannot be derived from these results via a direct approximation. The key in the following proof is decomposing the Riemann sum into interior part and boundary part, and we handle the boundary part via approximation.

Proof. omitted. □

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SCHOOL OF MATHEMATICS, SICHUAN UNIVERSITY, CHENGDU 610064, P. R. CHINA.
 Email address: lshengscu@gmail.com

SCHOOL OF MATHEMATICS, HUNAN UNIVERSITY, CHANGSHA 410082, P. R. CHINA.
 Email address: yeeyoe@163.com